VOLUME 2

$100M LEADS



ALEX HORMOZI

HOW TO GET **STRANGERS** TO **WANT TO BUY** YOUR STUFF

Acquisition.com Volume II

$100M Leads

How to Get Strangers To Want To Buy Your Stuff

Alex Hormozi

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Guiding Principles

Do more.

Thank Yous

To Trevor:

Thank you for your true friendship. Thank you for your tireless effort to extract the ideas out of my head. And, for your continued support in slaying the nihilism monster. People say you are lucky if you have one real friend in your entire life. Thank you for being the best friend a man could ask for.

To Leila:

Even though Lady Gaga said it first, it doesn't make it any less true.

"You found the light in me that I couldn't find.

The part of me that's you will never die."

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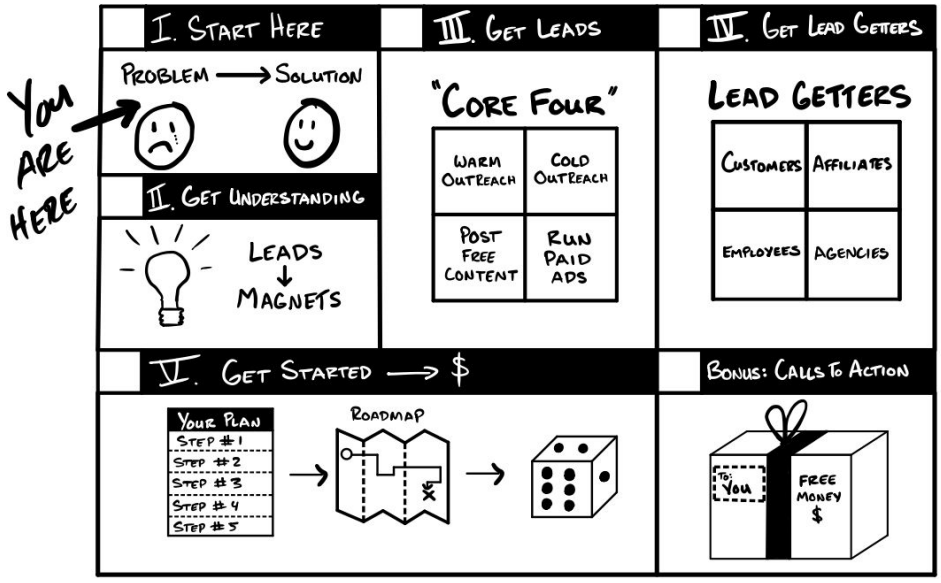
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Section I: Start Here

“It’s hard to be poor with leads bangin’ down your door” - Hormozi family jingle



You have to sell stuff to make money. It seems simple enough, but everyone tries to skip to the ‘make money’ part. It doesn’t work. I tried. You need *all* the pieces. You need the stuff to sell - an offer. You need people to sell it to - leads. Then you gotta get those people to buy it - sales. Once you put all those in place, *then* you can make money.

My first book, *$100M Offers*, covers the first step and gives you the *stuff*. It answers the age old question *“What should I sell?.”* Answer - an offer so good people feel stupid saying no. But strangers can only buy your stuff if they know you exist. This takes leads. “Leads” mean a lot of different things to a lot of different

people. But most agree that they're the first step to getting more customers. In simpler terms, it means they've got the problem to solve and the money to spend.

If you're reading this book, you already know leads don't magically appear. You need to go get them. More precisely, you need to help them find you so they can buy your stuff! And the best part is, you don't have to wait…you can *force* them to find you. You do that through advertising. **Advertising**, *the process of making known*, lets strangers know about the stuff you sell. If more people know about the stuff you sell, then you sell more stuff. If you sell more stuff, then you make more money. *Having lots of leads makes it hard to be poor.*

Advertising lets you have a terrible product... and still make money. It lets you be terrible at sales…and still make money. It lets you make a ton of mistakes and *still. make. money*. In short, having this skill gives you endless chances to *get it right*.

And in the unforgiving world of business, second chances are hard to come by. So you might as well load up. *Advertising is a skill worth having*.

And this book, *$100M Leads*, shows you *exactly* how to do it.

***

$100M Leads sits atop the foundation of my first book, *$100M Offers*. It assumes you already have a *Grand Slam Offer* to sell - the stuff. Once you have an offer to sell, it creates the next problem–*Who do I sell it to?* This book is my answer to that question. Leads. Lots of leads.

And before you know how to get leads, life *sucks.* You don't know where your next customer will come from. You scramble to cover rent and pay bills. You worry about laying people off, putting food on your table and… *going under*. You work your hardest to succeed, and others laugh at you for trying. It feels like death. I've been there. I get it. This book puts you in a better situation. One where you've got more leads than you can handle and more money than you can spend.

Here's How:

First, it explains how advertising works.

Second, it reveals the four core ways to get leads.

Third, it shows you how to get other people to do it for you.

Finally, it wraps up with a one-page advertising plan you can use to grow your business *today*.

***

Once you know how to get leads, life gets easier.

As for why you should blindly listen to me about getting more leads - don't. Make up your own darn mind! But, in the spirit of "walking the talk," here's my track record:

I advertise in a variety of industries through my holding company Acquisition.com. Our portfolio includes software, e-commerce, business services, consumer services, brick & mortar chains,

digital products, and plenty of others. Together, they make $250,000,000+ in annual revenue. And they do it by getting 20,000+ leads per day selling offers from $1 to $1,000,000+.

On the personal side, I have a lifetime average return on advertising of 36:1. That means for every $1 I spend on advertising, I get $36 back. A return of 3600%. Some people built their wealth in the stock market. Others in real estate. I built mine advertising.

This year I surpassed $100,000,000 in net worth at age 32. And if you're from the future, that's in 2022 US Dollars. Which, much to my dismay, came with no flyers. No awards. No parades. I'm still 2000x poorer than the richest man in the world. My life is pretty much the same. I'm still the same height, married to the same woman, and graying faster than when I was poor.

In these pages, I share the skills responsible for the bulk of my material success. I did it all using the advertising methods in this book. I left nothing out. This isn't a book of theories or armchair analysis. This book is built on what worked for me. And I wrote it hoping it'll work even better for you.

To answer a question I got after releasing my first book: "Why do your books look like they're written for kids?" The answer is simple: my books must be books I would read. And I have a short attention span. As such, I liken my reading preferences to that of a child: short in length, simple in words, and with lots of pictures. These books are my attempt to do that.

$100M Leads is about getting strangers to show interest in the stuff you sell. And once I transfer that skill to you, it's your turn to use it.

With that out of the way…let's get rich, shall we?

Pro Tip: Faster, Deeper Learning By Reading & Listening At Same Time

Here's a life hack I stumbled on years ago. If you listen to an audiobook and read the physical book or ebook at the same time, you read faster and remember more. You store the contents in more places in your brain. Nifty stuff. This is how I read books worth reading.

I also do both because I struggle to stay focused. If I listen to the audio while reading it helps me avoid zoning out. It took me two days to record this book out loud. I did it so if you struggle like me, you don't have to anymore.

If you want to give it a try, go ahead and grab the audio version and see for yourself. I hope you find it as valuable as I have.

I figured I'd put this "hack" early on. This way you'd have a chance to do it if you found the first chapter valuable enough to earn your attention.

Pro Tip: Hack For Finishing Books

I get distracted easily. So I need little tricks to keep my attention. This one helps me a lot: Finish chapters. Don’t stop in the middle. Completing a chapter gives you positive reinforcement. It keeps you going. So, if you meet a tough chapter, finish it so you can start fresh on the next one.

How I Got Here

"Hope is being able to see the light despite all the darkness" - Desmond Tutu

March 2017.

I felt hurried taps on my shoulder while working at my desk. It was Leila, my (then) girlfriend and business partner.

"What's up? You alright?"

"We have a problem." She said.

What now? I thought.

"Look at this." She shoved a stack of books out of the way to make room for her laptop.

"What am I looking at?" I squinted.

"A disaster."

She ran her finger down the screen to direct my gaze.

-$99… -$499…-$499… -$299…-$399… -$499…-$499…

Every other number was more than my rent.

“What are these?”

She started scrolling. “Refunds. All of them. From the two gyms we launched last month.”

“Wait. How? Why?”

She scrolled more. “I got lots of weird texts last night from the members we sold at the Kentucky gym. I guess the owner stood up on a chair and told everyone to refund and go home. He didn’t want to deal with all the new customers.”

"That's insane," I said.

She was still scrolling. "Yeah, and the other gym owner told his new customers he would take them for half price if they asked for refunds from us and paid him instead.”

“Wait what? They can’t do that.” I said.

“Well, they did.” *She scrolled faster, the numbers blurred*.

“Have you called them? That’s not allowed in the agreement." I said.

“Yea. I know. They’re ignoring my calls.”

I put my hand on hers. The refund waterfall froze in place. Hundreds of droplet-size reminders of how much I sucked.

“How bad is this? How many refunds? Just cutting profits? Or enough to go negative and owe money?” I tried to keep my voice steady. I failed.

Leila paused before answering. “It’s a hundred and fifty grand.” The number hung in the air. “...we won’t be able to pay my friends.”

Their faces flashed through my mind, and the little hope I had drained from my chest. A month earlier, I got her friends to quit their jobs for this. Now I had to tell them I didn’t have the money to pay them.

She continued. “We can’t sell our way out of this either. It’ll just create more refunds to deal with. And we’re out of money.” Her eyes met mine, looking for the answers she deserved. I had nothing.

I felt sick.

A year earlier-

I was good at getting leads for my gyms. I scaled to five locations in only three years. My claim to fame was opening my gyms up at full capacity on the first day. So, I opened as many as I could as fast as I could.

My fast pace started getting attention. I got asked to speak at a conference about my advertising method. To me though, I didn’t think my process was special. I figured everyone was doing it. So,

I walked through my presentation hoping I wasn't boring the audience. They were silent.

The moment I stepped off stage, a mob formed around me. They hurled questions at me left and right. I could barely keep up. They even followed me into the bathroom. I felt like a celebrity. It was wild. To this day, I've never been more bombarded in my life. Everyone wanted me to teach them how to do what I had just presented. They wanted my help. Me. But I had nothing to sell them. Although, over one hundred people left me their phone numbers and business cards in case I did. Then a wild idea came to me.

I could make some money doing this…

3 months later–an idea turns into a business

Since I used advertising to launch my gyms at full capacity I thought, maybe, I could "launch" other people's gyms to full capacity, too. I called the company Gym Launch. Original, I know.

My offer was simple. *I'll fill your gym in 30 days for free. You pay nothing. I pay for everything. I sell new members and keep the first 6 weeks of membership fees as payment. You get everything else. If I don't fill your gym, I don't make money. You spend nothing either way.*

It was an easy offer to sell. I'd fly out. Turn on my lead machine. Work the leads. Then sell the leads. Except, instead of selling them into my gym, I'd sell them into whatever gym I was camped at for the month. Every month I'd go to a new gym. Rinse and repeat. *It worked.*

Word of this kid who'd fill your gym for free got around fast. Unless I hired help, referrals would've booked me out for more than two years straight. I couldn't keep running my gyms *and* doing this, so I sold my gyms and went all in on Gym Launch.

I saw a problem though. I filled their gyms, and *they* got to keep all the long-term profits. I left so much money on the table. But, if I were part owner of some of the gyms, I could stack revenue month over month. *Bingo*. Not much later, one of the gym owners made such an offer. We'd be fifty-fifty. I would fill the gym with members, and he would fill it with staff. With this new model, I could open up 1 to 2 gyms per month and own them all. This would work much better than only collecting the upfront cash. A win-win partnership.

A slight hitch in the plan, though. My new partner had "poor financials." So nice guy Alex offered to pay all the expenses and take on all the liability for the first launch. I personally guaranteed the lease and would spend *my* time and money to fill it with members. Once filled, I would hand the gym over to him. I put all the money from selling my gyms, including my life savings, into this "launch and go" model. It took everything I had.

A few weeks later, halfway through the launch, I woke up to find all the money in the account gone. All of it. The partner accused me of stealing and took the money as "his share" of the profits. But, *we hadn't made any profit*. Then, he sent the money to a foreign contact and filed for bankruptcy. That's what he told me anyway. When I offered to walk through the financials and account for every dollar, he refused. That's when I knew I had made a terrible mistake.

It turns out he had been indicted for fraud a few years earlier. And to make matters worse, *I already knew*. He told me it was "just a

big misunderstanding." I believed him. As the saying goes, *when money meets experience... the money gets the experience, and the experience gets the money*. Lesson learned.

In three months, I went from a successful multi-location gym owner. To selling all my gyms. To a cool new launching gyms thing. To completely broke. Everything I made from selling my gyms was gone. My life savings was gone. Wiped out. All of it. Four years of work, saving, sleeping on the floor– erased in a…oh no… *Leila*.

Leila quit her life as she knew it to do this with me. She weathered my constant changes. She supported me in the half-baked partnership even though she opposed it. Even with this huge failure, she never once even hinted, *I told you so*. Instead, she told me, "The Gym Launch model is still good. Let's do more of those." So we did.

I put $3,300 *per day* on a credit card to pay for ads, airfare, hotels, rental cars, etc. for six sales reps. Leila's friends. I say this lightly, but I covered what a nightmare it was in the first book. So I won't repeat it here.

In the first month, we launched six gyms and collected $100,117. We made enough to cover the $100,000 credit card bill. And for the record, that meant I was still broke. The next month we made $177,399 with $30,000-$40,000 in profit. It gave me some room to breathe. *Finally*.

And that's when Leila tapped me on the shoulder to share $150,000 worth of bad news.

Now you're caught up.

The morning after Leila told me we had $150,000 in refunds and lost all our money. Again.

A honking horn startled me at 3 AM. My problems flooded back. *Welp. I'm awake now*. I pulled myself out of bed and slinked to my work corner. I walked over out of habit more than desire. I slid the chair out and plopped down - notebook and pen at the ready. I had to make $150,000 in profit, not revenue, in thirty days. And I had to do it with no money to my name, and no experience making that much profit in a month. Ever. So I started scribbling ideas:

…*Charge an upfront fee for new gyms*

…*Ask for a percentage of revenue from old gyms*

…*Get gyms I already launched to pre-pay for a future launch*

…*Call every old customer and sell them supplements over the phone*

I kept penciling the math. None of these would make enough money. Not in thirty days anyway. I felt glued to the chair. *I have to figure this out*. I stared at the notebook, hoping it knew something. It didn't. *God I suck*.

A few hours later, Leila woke up. Like clockwork, she walked into the kitchen and poured a cup of coffee. She got straight to work at the kitchen table behind me.

“Whatcha doin’?” I asked, trying to distract myself.

“Check-ins with online fitness clients.” she said.

“What does that bring in again?”

“$3600 last month.”

“What do you charge?”

“300 bucks a month. Why?”

“How long does it take you?”

“A few hours a week”

“And there’s no overhead? just time?"

“Yea…why?”

I plowed on “I know these are old personal training clients, but do you think you could do it with strangers?”

“I don’t know…probably…what’re you thinking?”.

“I think I have something.” I said.

“Wait, for what?”

“To come up with the hundred and fifty grand.”

“What, my online training? How?” She looked skeptical.

“We just cut the middleman and sell direct. I think I can just run ads to a sales page that books phone appointments. Then we can sell the fitness programs we’ve been selling at the gyms, but sell it as an online program. We already have the materials. We already know the ads work. And there won’t be any cost to fulfill. Plus, no more flights. No rentals. No motels. And no gym owner telling them to refund...”

She hesitated. “You think it could work?”

“Honestly…no idea. But every day we don’t do something is one less day to come up with the money.”

She thought hard. “Alright, let’s do it.”

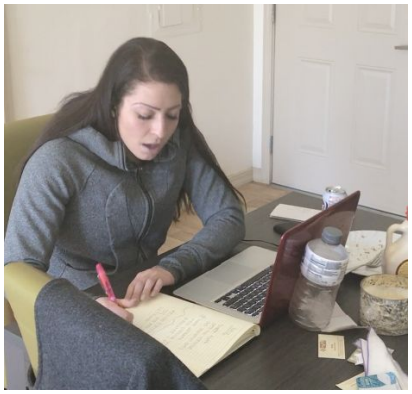
That was all I needed.

I worked thirty-eight hours straight to make the offer go live. A few hours later, leads started flowing. She took her first call the next day. I walked in as the call finished:

“$499...yea…and what card did you want to use?” *she had the candor of a pro*.

A few minutes later, I asked with anticipation, “Was that a sale??”

“Yep.” *Dang, she <u>is</u> a pro*.



I even snapped a picture of Leila closing our first sale because it felt so momentous.

Within days, we were doing $1000 per day in online fitness sales. We also got the cash up front with almost no risk of refunds. *This was working*. But, we were still *way* short of the $150,000.

At lunch, she listened to my master plan between mouthfuls. “Okay, the sales guys can stay home and sell this over the phone. If they do the same $1000 per day as you, with eight guys, we should hit $8,000 per day. In thirty days, we’ll make $240,000. After ad spend and commissions, we'll have enough to cover the $150,000.”

“What about the gyms we’re supposed to launch?”

“I’ll call 'em and tell ‘em we’re going in another direction. They haven't paid us anything, so there’s not much they can object to. I’ll start calling them after lunch.”

The first call was to a gym owner in Boise, Idaho.

“Hello?”

I looked down to read the bullet points on my little script. “Hey man - we’re not doing launches anymore. We’re selling direct-to-consumer weight loss. So we won't be coming out and–”

He interrupted. “But I *really* need this right now. I just refinanced my house and maxed out all my credit cards to keep my gym afloat. I put my life savings into this place. Is there any way you can help me? You launched my buddy’s gym. I know what you can do.”

Given my *worse than yours* situation, I didn’t care how bad his finances were. So I tried to sound polite. “I get that it’s a hard time, but we’re not flying out. I’m sorry.”

“Okay, okay. I get you can’t fly out. But is there any way you can just show me what to do? We really need this."

I was beat up, exhausted, broke, and felt betrayed by the entire industry. I should have said “no” but instead, I said… “Fine. I’ll show you how to get leads, but I'm not flying out there to save you if you can’t sell.”

“Totally get it. It’s on me. I can close. I just don't have anyone walking in the door. I need LEADS. How much to show me how to launch?”

I looked down at my script. *This is not how it was supposed to go*. I wanted to say no and hang up. Our weight loss offer was working, and I didn't want distractions. He’d already told me he

was broke, so I said the biggest number I could think of to get him off the phone.

“$6000. Consider it my ‘selling my secrets’ sale.”

“6k?”

“Yes. Six thousand.” I said, articulating the whole number, hoping to scare him off.

“6k? Okay - done.”

What. I stood there slack-jawed, frozen in disbelief. *Six. Thousand. Dollars*. I floated out of myself and watched the conversation happen. I still get choked up thinking about it.

“Oh…uhh…great…what card do you wanna use?” Now, trying *not* to scare away the *Six. Thousand. Dollars*. Panicked, I wrote his card information on the flap of a cardboard box.

“When do I start?” he asked.

“I’ll send you everything Monday morning.” Giving myself the insane task of packaging my entire gym leads and sales system in forty-eight hours. He agreed.

I hung up and sat in shock. Once I came to my senses, I ran the credit card. *$6000…success. Is this real?*

I desperately wanted to tell Leila, but she was on a sales call. Fifteen minutes later, she walked in.

“Got another one,” she said.

“You won’t believe this. I just sold our Gym Launch system for $6000 to the gym in Boise.”

“What? I thought we were doing weight loss.”

"Yea, I know. So did I, but…” She waited. “…I think we’re still in the gym business…I think we were just doing it wrong.” She needed more details. I didn’t have any yet. “I’m gonna call the gyms we planned to launch next month and see if they’ll buy it too.”

“Uhhh…okay.” She said.

The next call went the same except when he said “How much?” I said, “$8,000.” He agreed.

Next call, same thing, except I said, “$10,000.” He agreed.

All eight gyms we planned to launch said yes to licensing the launch materials instead. *In a single day, I collected $60,000 selling something with zero cost to fulfill*. In a single day, I was a third of the way out of my $150,000 prison. I spent five years developing that advertising system. It finally paid off. Doing the thing that scared me most - *giving away my secrets* - led to the biggest breakthrough in my life.

“I can’t believe it,” I said. “I think we can get out of this.”

“So… are we not doing the weight loss thing?”

“No. I guess not…I think we’ve had something here all along. We just had to put the pieces together.”

“Do you think anyone else will buy it?”

“I’m gonna call the thirty gyms we already launched. They know our system works because we did it in front of them. We also have some gym owner leads from that conference. That should cover the $150,000 and give us a clean slate.”

“Ok, then what? Is this what we’re gonna do?” She looked for some well-deserved stability.

“I mean - I think so? It makes more money than the other thing, and it’s way easier to deliver.” She agreed. “So after I call those leads, I’ll start running ads. I'll post our success stories in a few gym groups to get leads from there. And I’ll also tell the gyms I’ll pay $2000 cash for any gym they send that signs up. That gives us ad leads, content leads, *and* referral leads.”

***

In the next 30 days, we made $215,000 *in profit*. We covered the $150,000 in refunds with cash to spare. We did so well because the average gym using our advertising system added an extra $30,000 in cash in their first 30 days. *It made them more money than they paid for it*. It delivered - *in spades*. Plus, they got to keep all the cash. They loved it. Referrals poured in.

I found the processing records from May-June 2017, the month it all happened:

	Pending Authorizations		Charges		Refunds		Rtns/Chgbks		Voids		Declines		Totals	
	Count	Amount	Count	Amount	Count	Amount	Count	Amount	Count	Amount	Count	Aprvl Pct	Count	Amount
01/2017	0	$0.00	348	$102,605.64	7	$-2,488.33	0	$0.00	12	$2,002.98	148	70%	**515**	**$100,117.31**
02/2017	0	$0.00	847	$190,809.50	56	$-13,243.77	1	$-166.00	5	$1,247.00	232	78%	**1141**	**$177,399.73**
03/2017	0	$0.00	782	$177,820.58	61	$-12,701.50	4	$-997.00	21	$3,458.50	285	73%	**1153**	**$164,122.08**
04/2017	0	$0.00	704	$204,461.25	49	$-10,725.00	10	$-6,315.00	2	$-50.00	354	67%	**1119**	**$187,421.25**
05/2017	0	$0.00	191	$260,754.00	4	$-797.00	11	$-16,984.00	0	$0.00	42	82%	**248**	**$242,973.00**
06/2017	0	$0.00	214	$272,835.00	5	$-1,498.00	30	$-55,375.00	0	$0.00	1	100%	**250**	**$215,962.00**
07/2017	0	$0.00	282	$316,917.98	0	$0.00	21	$-23,450.00	0	$0.00	7	98%	**310**	**$293,467.98**
08/2017	0	$0.00	346	$393,370.62	0	$0.00	28	$-32,998.99	1	$100.00	45	88%	**420**	**$360,371.63**
09/2017	0	$0.00	478	$543,376.29	1	$-1,000.00	64	$-65,792.00	0	$0.00	41	92%	**584**	**$476,584.29**
10/2017	0	$0.00	799	$828,709.31	7	$-5,798.00	50	$-49,887.00	8	$8,000.00	31	96%	**895**	**$773,024.31**
11/2017	0	$0.00	1076	$1,132,319.31	8	$-8,000.00	66	$-64,296.00	1	$1.00	92	92%	**1243**	**$1,060,023.31**
12/2017	0	$0.00	1315	$1,363,956.31	13	$-17,296.00	83	$-82,099.00	1	$1,000.00	111	92%	**1523**	**$1,264,561.31**
01/2018	0	$0.00	1609	$1,621,972.81	15	$-28,175.00	97	$-88,995.00	8	$9,000.00	102	94%	**1831**	**$1,504,802.81**
Totals	**0**	**$0.00**	**8991**	**$7,409,908.60**	**226**	**$-101,722.60**	**465**	**$-487,354.99**	**59**	**$24,759.48**	**1491**	**86%**	**11232**	**$6,820,831.01**

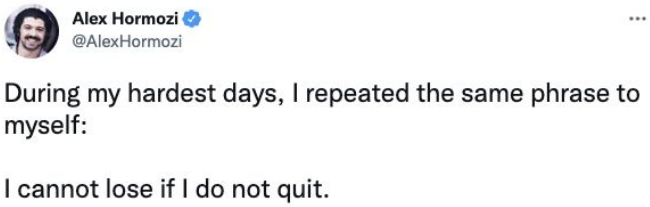
We finished that first year at $6,820,000 in revenue. The next calendar year we did $25,900,000 in revenue and $17,000,000 in profit. Yea, *tens of millions*. It was insane. Like, nuts. The company continues to this day with 4500+ gym locations and counting. And no one is more surprised than me. Something I made actually worked... *finally*.

In 2018 we started Prestige Labs to sell supplements through our gym client base. We used Prestige Labs and the gyms as an affiliate network to generate weight loss leads for each other. In 2019, we started ALAN. A new type of software company that worked leads for local businesses. In 2020, we founded Acquisition.com as a holding company for our business interests. In 2021, we sold 75% of ALAN to a bigger company. I’m not allowed to say for how much, but ALAN did $12,000,000 in revenue in the prior twelve months. So you can use your imagination. We sold 66% of our supplement and gym licensing business to American Pacific Group at a $46,200,000 valuation. And that was after taking $42,000,000 in owner pay over the first 4 years.

I share this because I can still hardly believe it. All this was because of a girl who believed in me, a credit card, and *the ability to get leads.*

Important Disclaimer

Knowing how to get leads saved my business, my reputation, and likely my life. It was the only way I stayed afloat. It was the reason I kept getting second, third, fourth, and fifth chances.



I advertised a lot of different things, in a lot of different ways. I advertised to get member leads for local gyms. I advertised to get online weight loss leads for Leila. I advertised to get gym owner leads to sell business services. I advertised to get affiliate leads for our supplement company. I advertised to get agency leads for our software. And so on. Getting leads has been my *get out of jail free* card with no expiration date. And at this point, it's faded and worn with use.

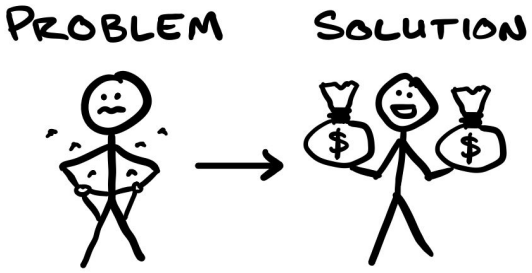
I'd like to share this skill with you. I can show you how to get more leads. And here is your first piece of good news: by reading these words, you're already in the top 10 percent. Most people buy stuff and never crack it open. I'll also throw out a spoiler: the further you read, the bigger the nuggets get. Just watch.

Thank you from the bottom of my heart. Thank you for allowing me to do work I find meaningful. Thank you for lending me your most valuable asset—your attention. I promise to do my best to give you the highest possible return on it. This book delivers.

The world needs more entrepreneurs. It needs more fighters. It needs more magic. And that’s what I’m sharing with you — magic.

The Problem This Book Solves

“Leads, lots of leads.”



You have a problem:

You're not getting as many leads as you want because you're not advertising enough. Period. As a result, your potential customers are ignorant of your existence. How sad! This means less money flows your way.

So now that you know you have a problem, unless you hate helping people and making money, you kinda have to solve it.

How this book solves it:

To make more money, you’ve gotta grow your business. You can only grow your business in two ways:

1) Get more customers

2) Make them worth more

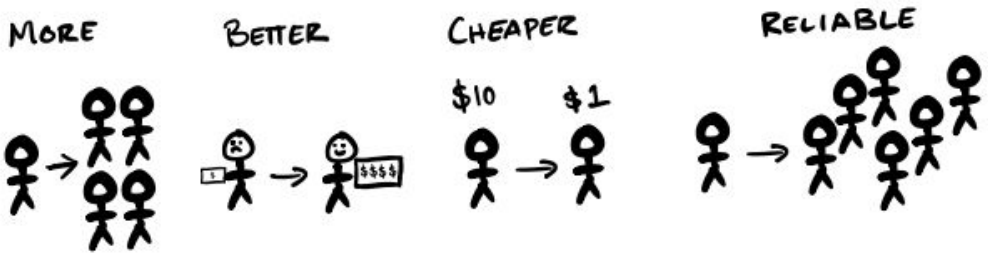
That's it. I grow our portfolio companies with this exact framework. *$100M Leads* focuses on number one - getting more customers. You get more customers by getting:

1) More Leads

2) Better Leads

3) Cheaper Leads

4) Reliably (think 'from lots of places').



Bottom line: All else being equal…when you double your leads, you double your business.

This book shows you how to transform your business into a lead-getting machine. Once you apply its models, you *instantly* increase lead flow. And, like cash flow, when leads flow, it's hard not to make money. This book will solve your "not getting enough leads" problem for good.

In a nutshell: I will show you how to get strangers to *want* to buy your stuff.

What's In It For Me?

In one word: ***trust***.

I give this book and the course that comes with it for free (or at cost) in hopes of earning your trust. I want this book to provide more value than any $1000 course, $30,000 coaching program, or $100,000 degree. Although I could sell these materials that way, *I don't want to*. I have a different model. I explain it below.

Who am I looking to help?

I want to provide value to two types of entrepreneurs. The first is *under* $1,000,000 per year in profit. My goal is to help you get to $1,000,000 in profit per year (fo' free) and, in so doing, *earn your trust*. Try a couple of tactics from this book, get some leads, then try a few more, and get more leads. The more leads you get, the better.

Do it enough, and you become the second type of entrepreneur: the type making over $1,000,000 in EBITDA (fancy word for profit) per year. Once you get there, or if that's you now, it would be my honor to invest in your business and help you scale.

I don't sell coaching, masterminds, courses, or anything like that… I invest. I buy equity in growing, profitable, bootstrapped companies. Then, I use the systems, resources, and teams of *all my companies* to fast-track the growth of *your* company.

But don't believe me yet...*we just met*.

Author Note: Our Investment Criteria Have Changed Since Last Book

If you noticed some changes in our investment criteria - you're right. We changed our minimum investment threshold from $3,000,000 in revenue to $1,000,000 in profit.

On top of that, we also used to primarily invest in education and service businesses. But our portfolio has expanded. We've done quite well outside of those industries. So now, as long as a business meets our size requirements and is profitable, cash flowing, and growing, we consider investing in it.

My Business Model



ACQUISITION.COM

My business model is simple:

1) Provide better free products than the marketplace's paid products.

2) Earn the trust of entrepreneurs who make over $1,000,000 per year in profit.

3) Invest in those entrepreneurs to fast-track their growth.

4) Help everyone else for free, for good.

Our process reverse-engineers success. The winners know my models will work for them because they already have. And I know the winners will use them because they already do. So, we operate on shared trust.

This approach avoids failures *and* increases the likelihood of success. Win-win. Easy to say, but let me show you how much of a difference our process makes…

Within the first 12 months, our average portfolio company **1.8x's revenue and 3.01x's profits**. And we partner for the long haul, that's just the first 12 months. Our average portfolio company who's been with us between 12 and 24 months, **2.3x's revenue and 4.7x's profits**. As a fun exercise, plug your numbers in to see what that would look like for you. This stuff works.

That's how I know the models I'm about to show you work. *They already have*.

Acquisition.com's Mission

To make real business accessible to everyone. Businesses solve problems. Businesses make the world better. There are too many problems for any one person to solve.

And I can't cure cancer, end hunger, or solve the world's energy crisis (for now). But I *can* provide value to the entrepreneurs who build the businesses that will. I want to help create as many businesses as possible so we can solve as many problems as we can. So I share these business-building frameworks rather than hoard them. Fair enough?

Cool. Let's press on.

Basic Outline of This Book

I laid this book out from zero clients, zero leads, zero advertising, zero money, zero skills (Section II) to max clients, max leads, max advertising, max money, and max skills (Section IV). We learn more skills as we progress in the book. And when we have more skills, we can get *more leads in the same amount of time*. So, we finish with the most complex skills that get us the most leads for our time spent. We save them for the end because they take lots of skills *and* money. And, getting good and having money takes time. I want this book to help a person get their first five clients ***and*** crack their first ten million-dollar month and beyond.

This order also reminds those *with* skills and money, me included, of the basics we stopped doing. *Our businesses deserve better.* Respecting the tried-and-true methods that got you to your current level will probably get you to the next one. *Masters never don't do the basics.*

So, we go from getting your first lead all the way to building a $100,000,000+ leads machine. Here's the breakdown:

Section I: *You're about to finish reading it right now*.

Section II: I reveal what makes advertising *really* work. Most entrepreneurs think about advertising the wrong way. Since they think about advertising the wrong way, they do the wrong stuff to get leads. You want to do the right stuff to get leads. *This is the way.*

Section III: We learn advertising's "core four." There are only four ways to get leads. So if there is a most important "how to" section, it's this one.

Section IV: We learn how to get other people (customers, employees, agencies, and affiliates) to do it all for you. And this completes the assembly of your fully functioning *$100M Leads* machine.

Section V: We wrap up with a one-page advertising plan you can use to get more leads *today*.

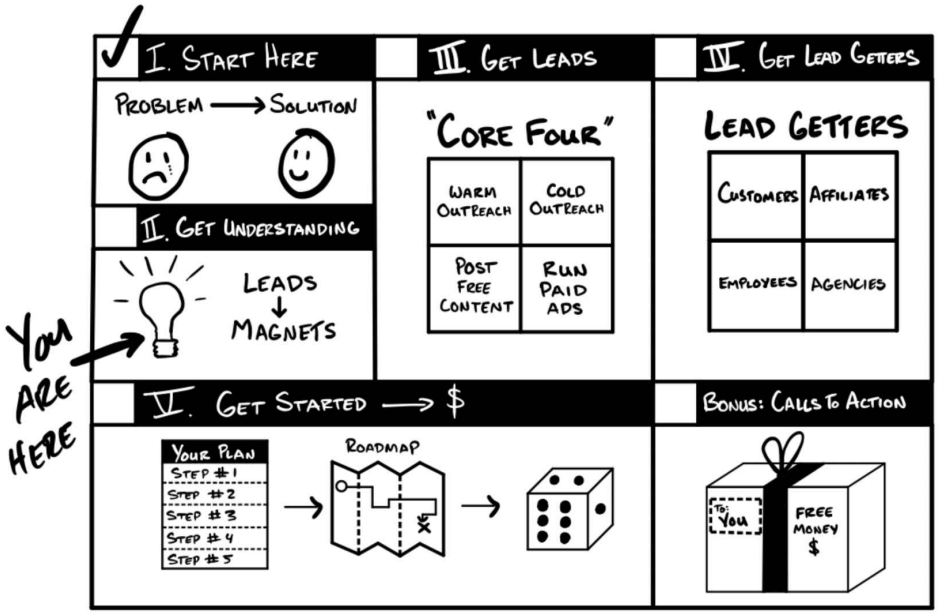
GOLDEN TICKET:

We invest in companies over $1,000,000+ in profit to help them scale. If you would like us to invest in your business to scale, go to **Acquisition.com**. You can also find **free** books and courses so good they grow your business without your consent. And if you don't like typing, you can scan the QR Code below to grab them.


SCAN ME

Section II: Get Understanding

Advertising. Simplified.



In this section, we cover three things to make sure advertising does exactly what we want it to do.

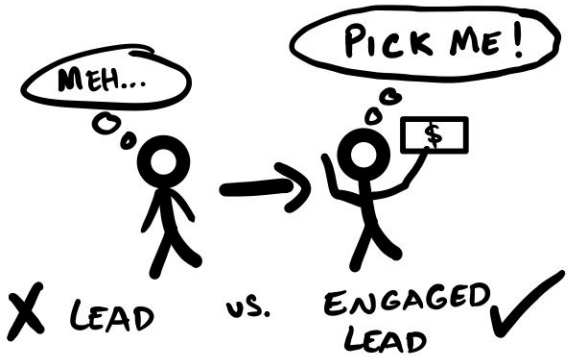
First, we talk about what a lead actually is. If we want more of them, then we better be darn well sure we're talking about the same thing. Second, we learn how to separate leads that make you money from leads that waste your time. Third, I show you the best ways I know to get the leads that make you money to *show interest in the stuff you sell.*

Let's dive in.

Leads Alone Aren’t Enough

“If you cannot explain something in simple terms, then you don’t understand it.”

- Dr. Richard Feynman, Nobel Prize Winner in Physics



I’ll let you in on a little secret. This book started because somebody asked me what a lead was. You’d think it would be simple, but I couldn’t give a straight answer. And after six months of trying to figure it out, I was more confused than before. It became clear *I didn't know as much about leads as I thought*. My search for a *clear* definition of “a lead” snowballed into the massive project that became *$100M Leads.* All this to say, we’ve got to agree on what the heck a lead is before we dive head first into getting them...

So what’s a lead anyways?

Someone who clicks an ad?

A phone number?

A person that schedules a call?

A list of names?

A door you knock on?

A walk-in?

An email address?

A subscriber?

A person that sees your content?

Etc…

You see, words matter because they affect how we think. How we think affects what we do. And if words have us thinking the wrong way, then we will probably do the wrong stuff. I hate doing the wrong stuff. So to do the right stuff more and the wrong stuff less, it's best we know what words mean and use them.

To cut the suspense, a **lead** is a *person you can contact*. That's all. If you bought a list of emails, those are leads. If you get contact information from a website or database, those are leads. The numbers in your phone are leads. People on the street are leads. *If you can contact them, they are leads.*

But what I came to realize was - *leads alone aren't enough*. We want ***engaged*** **leads:** *people who *show* interest in the stuff you*

sell. If someone *gives* their contact information on a website, that is an engaged lead. If someone *follows* you on social media and you can contact them, that is an engaged lead. If people *reply* to your email campaign, they are engaged leads. The leads *showing interest* are the leads that matter.

Engaged leads are the true output of advertising.

Getting more *engaged* leads is the point of this book. But I couldn't call the book "engaged leads" because no one would get it. But now you do. So the next question is: *How do we get leads to engage?*

Engage Your Leads: Offers and Lead Magnets

“I don’t do drugs. I am drugs” - Salvador Dali



April 2016.

I paid $25,000 to be in this group, and *everyone* told me to do a webinar. In fact, my mentor at the time told me, “Do a webinar every week until you make a million dollars. Until then, don’t ask me about anything else.” *This is my only path to success. I’ve got to figure this out.*

A webinar, as I understood it, was a magical presentation with a zillion slides. If somebody watched, it would hypnotize them into buying my thing.

There was so much I didn't know. Landing pages. Registration pages. Follow-up emails. Replay emails. Cart close emails. Presentation software. Website integration. Writing ads. Making ad creative. Figuring out where to put the ads. Who to show the ads to. Building a payment page. Processing payments. Never mind *making the actual webinar*. The list overwhelmed me.

So, I started with what I understood most, the landing page. I built a few of those for my gyms. My mentor made millions with webinars, so I modeled his landing page. But I didn't need it to make millions. I just needed it to make *something*.

Okay...now the "thank you" page.

An entire Sunday later, the "thank you" page went live. *Now for the big test.* I put my email into the landing page, clicked "sign me up," and waited. My brand new thank you page loaded. *Success.* I still wasn't a millionaire, sad face. But it was something.

The following Sunday, I sat down for my regular 'work *on* the business, not *in* the business' ritual. I had ten hours to figure out the next piece of this webinar puzzle. After my first cup of coffee, I decided I didn't really want to work, but I still wanted to feel productive. So I went to my advertising group's forum to get some tips.

"Just got off my webinar. $32k in an hour! I ROI'd the entire tuition in my first week! Webinars rock!"

I'm never gonna make this work. He joined the same month as me. He was in the same industry as me. He figured out how to make money with his webinar before me. He was stealing all the clients before I even got a chance. *Everyone is making money except me.*

Desperate, I called other people in the group. "I will do anything for your business: build a sales team… write your sales scripts… fix your sales process… anything… just *help me finish this webinar*…please?" One person agreed to help me. *Thank God.*

Eight Sundays later, and the little circle next to my ad campaign turned green. *It's alive!* I was officially spending $150 per day on ads. All I had to do now was watch the money pour in. I was gonna be rich!

Three days, $450, 80 leads, and 0 sales later…

I shut it all down. *I suck.*

No one even watched my webinar. Meanwhile, that guy posted *again* about how much money he was making off this webinar stuff. *Why do I suck so much?*

I spent most of my money to join this group, and I just set *another* $450 on fire. I didn't have the money to fail again. I *needed* the next thing to work. And if I couldn't even get anyone to watch, what was the point?

The case study:

I scrolled my newsfeed to see what other people were doing. An ad caught my eye. "Free Case Study on How I Spent $1 and Made $123,000 in a Weekend" or something like that. I punched in my email, and the page sent me to a video of walking through a successful advertising campaign. Nothing fancy. No slides. No "presenting." Just a dude explaining how his stuff worked.

This, I can do.

I fired up my screen recorder:

Okay everyone. So here's the ad account of a gym we just launched. Here are the ads we ran. This is how much we spent. We sent them to this page with this offer. You can see how many leads we got here. They got this many people scheduled. This many showed. This is how many they sold. This is how much the gym owner made. This is everything we did. If you want help setting something like this up, we'll do the whole thing for free. And we only get paid off the sales you make. If that sounds fair, book a call.

It took maybe 13 minutes. Simple. I swapped the webinar out for this video and changed the headline:

"FREE Case Study: How we added 213 members and $112,000 in revenue to a small gym in San Diego."

They would book a call on the next page.

I set up a fresh ad campaign and went to bed.

The next morning…

"Alex…what did you do?" Leila asked.

"What do you mean?"

"Strangers have booked my calendar solid for like the next week."

“Really?”

“Yea. Did you start a new campaign or something?”

“Yea… but I didn’t think it would go live so fast. Wait. People booked calls!?”

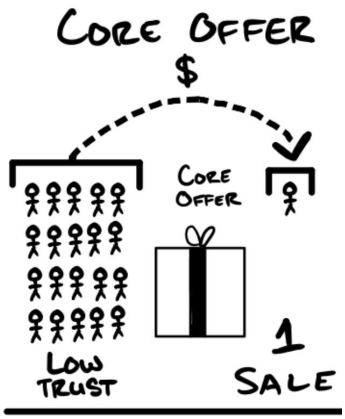
“Yea. Tons.”

Seeing Leila’s calendar stacked with appointments filled me with joy. *It’s working!*

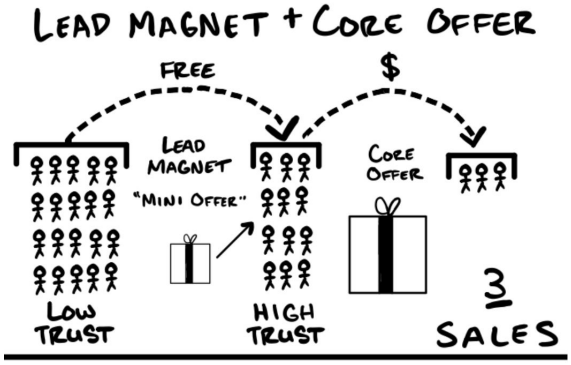
I learned an important lesson. *They didn't want my webinar. But they did want my case study.* This accidental discovery showed me how getting leads actually works…you have to *give people something they want.* The best part is - it’s easier than you think.

> **Author Note: Webinars Still Work**
>
> Obviously, they worked for the other guy in my group. But I didn’t have the skills at the time to make it work. I was so scarred from my first experience, I didn’t try another webinar for years. Spend your time testing the offer rather than perfecting an untested product. This was my breakthrough. I just needed to give people something simple that they wanted. For gym owners, it was a case study showing how I filled gyms in 30 days.

Lead Magnets Get Leads to Engage



Offers are what you promise to give in exchange for something of value. Often, a business promises to give its product or service in exchange for money. This is a *core offer.* If you advertise your core offer, then you go straight for the sale–the direct path to money. Advertising your core offer might be all you need to get leads to engage. Try this way first.



Sometimes, though, people want to know more about your offer before they buy. This is common for businesses that sell more expensive stuff. If that's you, then you'll often get more leads to engage by advertising with a lead magnet first. A **lead magnet** is a complete solution to a narrow problem. It's typically a lower-cost or free offer to see who is interested in your stuff. And, once solved, it reveals another problem *solved by your core offer*. This is important because leads interested in lower-cost or free offers *now* are more likely to buy a related higher-cost offer *later*.

Think of it like salty pretzels at a bar. If somebody eats the pretzels, they'll get thirsty and order a drink. The salty pretzels solve the narrow problem of hunger. They also reveal a thirst problem solved by a drink, which they can get, *in exchange for money*. The pretzels have a cost, but when done right, the drink revenue covers the cost of the pretzels *and* nets a profit.

So your lead magnet should be valuable enough on its own that you *could* charge for it. And, after they get it, they should want *more* of what you offer. This gets them one step closer to buying your stuff. *A person who pays with their time now is more likely to pay with their money later.*

Good lead magnets get more engaged leads and customers than a core offer alone, and do it for less money. So let's make a lead magnet, shall we?

> **Pro Tip: Even Free Stuff Has A Cost**
>
> People will give you time before they'll give you money. But, time is still a cost. If your lead magnet isn't worth their time, *it's overpriced*. And, free or not, they won't buy from you again.
>
> So look at it this way–*if they think your lead magnet is worth their time, they'll think your core offer is worth their money.*

Seven Steps To Creating an Effective Lead Magnet

Step 1: Figure out the problem you want to solve and who to solve it for

Step 2: Figure out how to solve it

Step 3: Figure out how to deliver it

Step 4: Test what to name it

Step 5: Make it easy to consume

Step 6: Make it darn good

Step 7: Make it easy for them to tell you they want more

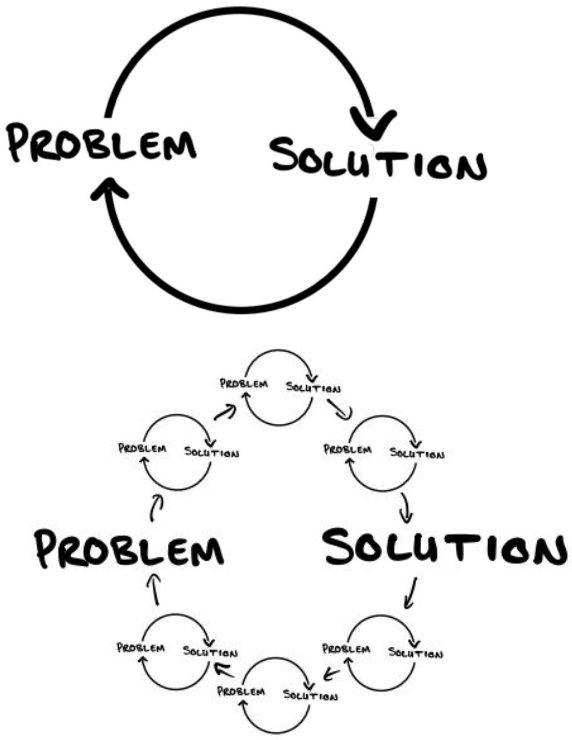
Something to keep in mind before we start - Grand Slam Offers work for free stuff as much or better than they do for paid stuff. So make your lead magnet so insanely good people will feel stupid saying no. And yes, this means you may have a few insanely valuable offers (even if some are free). But that's a *good* thing. The business that provides the most value wins. Period. So let's get started.

Step 1: Figure out the problem you want to solve and who to solve it for

Here's a simple example we can walk through together…this book is a lead magnet. You are a lead. I want to solve an engaged lead

problem. And I want to solve it for businesses making *less than* $1,000,000 in annual profit. With enough engaged leads, they can make *more than* $1,000,000+ in annual profit. Then, they qualify for my core offer: me investing in their company to help them scale.

The first step is picking the problem to solve. I use a simple model to figure this out. I call it the Problem-Solution cycle. You can see it below.



Every problem has a solution. Every solution reveals more problems. This is the never-ending cycle of business (and life). And, smaller problem-solution cycles sit inside larger problem-solution cycles. So how do we pick the right problem to solve?

We start by picking a problem that's narrow *and* meaningful. Then, solve it. And, like we just learned, when we solve one problem, a

new problem reveals itself. Here comes the important part- *if we can solve that new problem with our core offer, we've got a winner.* This is because we solve this new problem *in exchange for money.* That's it. Don't overthink it.

Example: Imagine we help homeowners sell their homes. That is a *broad* solution. But what about the steps *before* selling a home? Owners want to know what their house is worth. They want to know how to increase its value. They need pictures. They need it cleaned. They need landscaping. They need minor things fixed. They need moving services. They may need staging. Etc. These are all *narrow* problems–great for lead magnets. We pick one of the narrow problems and solve it for free. And although it helps, it makes their other problem more obvious–*they still have to sell their home.* But now we've earned their trust. So we can charge to solve the remaining problems with our core offer and help them achieve their broader goal.

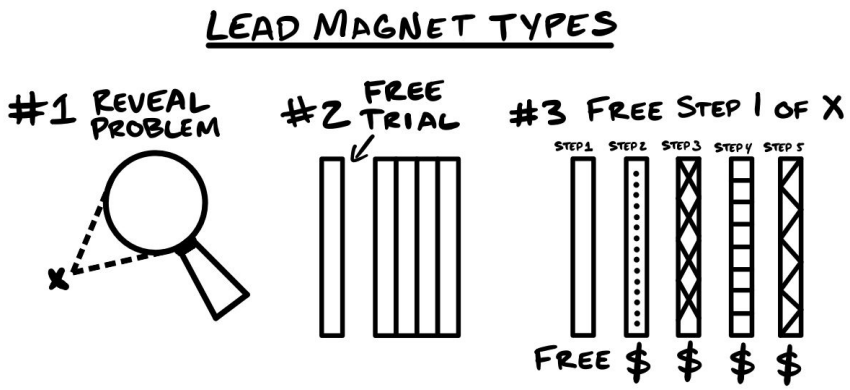
Action Step: Pick the narrowly defined problem you want to solve. Then, make sure your core offer can solve the next problem that comes up.

Step 2: Figure out how to solve it

There are three types of lead magnets and each offers a different type of solution.

First, if your audience has a problem they don't know about, your lead magnet would make them aware of it. Second, you could solve a recurring problem for a short amount of time with a sample or trial of your core offer. Third, you can give them one step in a multi-step process that solves a bigger problem. All three solve one

problem and reveal others. So your three types are: 1) Reveal Problems, 2) Samples and Trials, and 3) One Step Of A Multi-Step Process.



1) **Reveal Their Problem**. Think “diagnosis.” These lead magnets work great when they reveal problems <u>that get worse the longer you wait</u>.

    - Example: You run a speed test that shows their website loads at 30% below the speed it should. You draw a clear line between where they should be and how much money they lose by being below standards.

    - Example: You do a posture analysis and show them what their posture should look like. You draw a clear line to what their pain-free life would look like if their posture were fixed and how you can help.

    - Example: You do a termite inspection that reveals what happens when the bugs eat their home. If they do have termites, you can get rid of them for cheaper than the cost of… another home. If they don’t, they can pay you to prevent the termites from coming to begin with! You can sell ‘em either way. Win-win!

2) **Samples And Trials**. You give full but brief access to your core offer. You can limit the number of uses, time they have access, or both. This works great when your core offer is a recurring solution to a recurring problem.

    - Example: You hook them up to your faster server and show their website loading at lightning speed. They get more customers from your faster load times. If they want to keep it, they need to keep paying you.

    - Example: You give a free adjustment for their bad posture and they experience relief. To get permanent benefits, they must buy more.

    - Example: Food, cosmetics, medicine, or any other *consumable*s. Consumables, by nature, have limited uses and solve recurring problems... with recurring use. So single serving, “fun sized,” etc. samples are great lead magnets. It’s how Costco sells more food than other stores–they give out samples!

Pro Tip: Be A Drug Dealer

Many people make money selling drugs (legally and illegally). A free drug sample is a lead magnet. They can afford to give a 'hit' away because once people try it, they're hooked. It's so good, they come back for more. This is why we don't 'dilute' the value of our lead magnets or give away sucky fluff. If anything, like a drug dealer, you'd wanna give the strongest 'hit' *first*. It keeps them coming back for more. Your lead magnet is your first 'hit.' The next one they have to pay for. Be a (legal) drug dealer, and you'll make money like one.

PS - Whatever you do, make sure it's legal.

3) **One Step Of A Multi-Step Process**. When your core offer has steps, you can give one valuable step for free and the rest when they buy. This works great when your core offer solves a more complex problem.

    - Example: This book. I help you get to $1,000,000+ per year in profit. Then you'll have new problems we can help you solve, and scale from there.

    - Example: You give away a free wood sealant for a garage door. But the sealing process requires three different coats to protect from all weather conditions. I do the first one free, explain how it only gives partial coverage, and offer the other two in a bundle.

    - Example: You give away free finance courses, guides, calculators, templates, etc. They are so valuable people really can do it all themselves. But, they also reveal the time, effort,

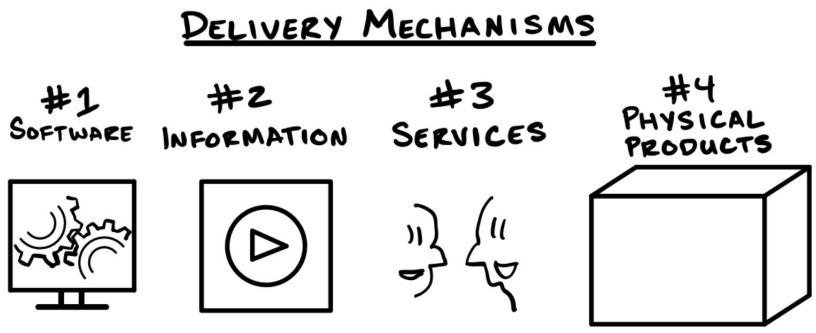
and sacrifice of doing it all. So you offer financial services to solve all that.

Action Step: Pick how you want to solve your narrowly defined problem.

Author Note: What We Can Learn from Dressing Rooms "Try Before You Buy"

Years ago, you weren't allowed to try things on before you bought them. Then, one savvy business owner created a fitting room. Their sales presumably skyrocketed. So much so, that it's now a standard practice in *all* clothes stores. Here's why the dressing room is so powerful - it is all three types of lead magnet *in one*. You get to try something on - *like a trial*. It also *reveals a problem* as once you try one thing on, you might find that you need something different than you intended. And once you find a shirt you like…a good salesperson would say "do you want pants to go with it?" It becomes step one on a multi-step process of creating *an outfit*. So if you can, try and get a lead magnet that does all three: reveal a problem, give them a taste of the solution, and show it as a small piece of a total package.

Step 3: Figure out how to deliver it



There are unlimited ways to solve problems. But my favorite lead magnets solve them with: software, information, services, and physical products. And each of those works great with the three types of lead magnets from step two. I'll show you what I've done to attract gym owners using each lead magnet type.

1) Software: *You give them a tool*. If you have a spreadsheet, calculator, or small software, your technology does a job for them.

   Ex: I give away a spreadsheet or dashboard that gives a gym owner all their relevant business stats, compares them to industry averages, then gives them a rank.

2) Information: *You teach them something*. Courses, lessons, interviews with experts, keynote presentations, live events, mistakes and pitfalls, hacks/tips, etc. Anything they can learn from.

   Ex: I give away a mini course for gyms on how to write an ad.

3) Services: *You do work for free*. Adjust their back. Perform a website audit. Apply the first layer of garage sealant. Transform their video into an ebook. Etc.

   Ex: I run gym owner's ads for free for thirty days.

4) Physical Products: *You give them something they can hold in their hands*. A posture assessment chart, a supplement, a small bottle of garage door sealant, boxing gloves to get boxing gym leads, etc.

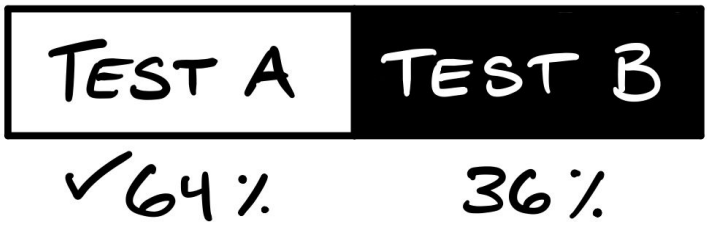
Ex: I sell a book for gym owners called *Gym Launch Secrets*.

With three different types of lead magnets and four ways to deliver them, that's up to twelve lead magnets that solve a single narrow problem. So many magnets, so little time!

I make as many versions of a lead magnet as I can and rotate them. This keeps the advertising fresh *and* low effort. Plus, you see which ones work best. Like my case study story at the beginning of the chapter, the results are often surprising. And you won't know until you try.

Action Step: As a thought exercise, think of a lead magnet and then a version of it for each delivery method. You always can, I promise. Then, pick how to deliver *your* lead magnet.

Step 4: Test What To Name It

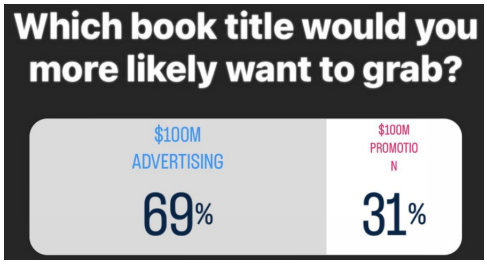


David Ogilvy said, "When you have written your headline, you have spent 80 cents of your (advertising) dollar." What that means is, five times more people read your headline than any other part of

your promotion. They read it and make a snap decision to read further… or not. Like Ogilvy hints, leads have to notice your lead magnet *before* they can consume it. Like it or not, this means how we present it matters more than anything. For example, improving the headline, name, and display of your lead magnet can 2x, 3x, or 10x your engagement. It's *that* important. Besides, if no one shows interest in your lead magnet, no one will ever know how good it is. You can't leave it to chance. So listen up. Here's what you do next - **<u>you test</u>**.

The three things you'll want to test are the headline, the image(s), and the subheadline, in that order. The headline is the most important. So if you only test one thing, test that. For example, I had no idea what to title this book. So here's what I did to figure out which name would do the best - **I tested**. The results may surprise you as much as they surprised me.

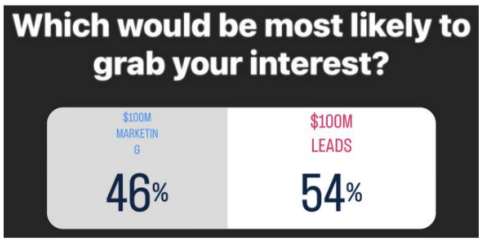
<u>Headline Tests</u>



<u>Round I:</u> Advertising ✔ vs. Promotion



<u>Round II:</u> Advertising vs. Leads ✔



<u>Round III:</u> Marketing vs. Leads ✔

<u>Image Test</u>

✔ Real vs. Cartoon



<u>Subheadlines</u>

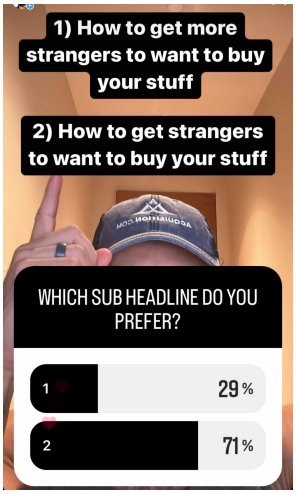
Round I:



“How to get more people to want to buy your stuff”

“How to get strangers to want to buy your stuff” ✔

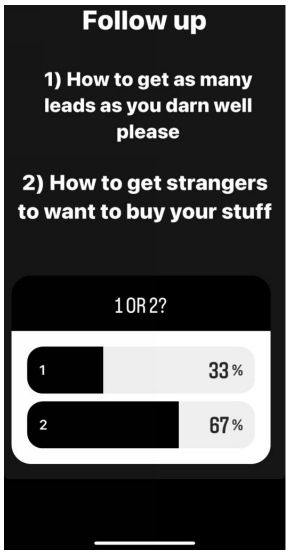
Round II:



How to get more strangers to want to buy your stuff”

“How to get strangers to want to buy your stuff” ✔

<u>Round III:</u>



“How to get as many leads as you darn well please”

“How to get strangers to want to buy your stuff” ✔

Round IV:



“Get strangers to want to buy your stuff”

“How to get strangers to want to buy your stuff” ✔

Note two things with the subheadline tests:

1) “How to get strangers to want to buy your stuff” overwhelmingly beat “Get strangers to want to buy your stuff.” The only difference is two little words: “how to.” And it also beat “how to get *more* strangers to want to buy your stuff” with a single word removed ‘*more.*’ Small changes can make big differences.

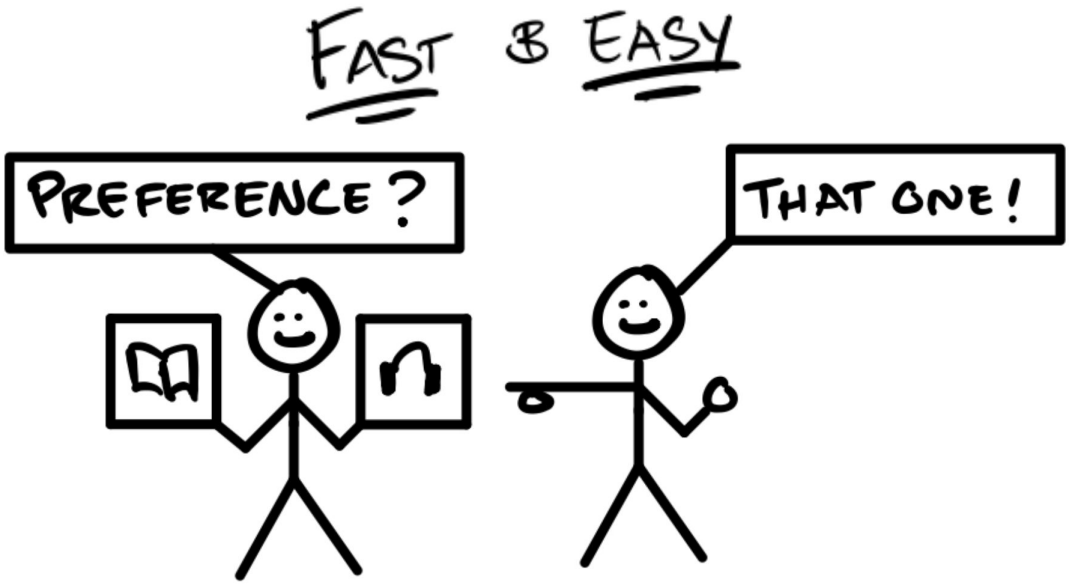
2) Since so many people asked, I figured I’d answer it here. I didn’t subtitle the book “How to get strangers to buy your stuff” because that’s sales, not getting leads. The point of this book is to get strangers to show interest, not to buy (yet). A raised hand is where this book ends. *‘$100M Sales’* or *'Persuasion'* (I haven't decided yet) will be a future book. One problem at a time.

Action Step: Test. If people engage in droves, you’ve got a winner.

And if you have any following at all, you can run polls like these. You don't need a lot of votes to get a directional idea. If you can’t do that, make a post on every platform and ask people to respond with a ‘1’ or a ‘2’, then count ‘em up. If you still can’t even do that, then just message people and ask. There’s always a way, and this is one of the highest leverage things you can do with your time - make sure how you package it gets engagement and you give yourself a big head start.

Bonus Points: If people respond to the poll ***and*** ask when they can get their hands on it, you have a mega winner.

Step 5: Make it easy for them to consume



People prefer to do things that take less effort. So if we want more people to take us up on our lead magnet, and consume it, we gotta make it easy. You can see 2x, 3x, and even 4x+ increases in take rates *and* consumption simply by making it easier to consume.

1) Software: You want to make it accessible on their phones, on a computer and in multiple different formats. This way, they'll pick the one easiest for them.

2) Information: People like to consume things in different ways. Some people like watching, other people like reading, others like listening, etc. Make your solution in as many different formats as you can: images, video, text, audio, etc. Offer them all. That's why this book comes in every format people consume.

3) Services: Be available at more times in more ways. More times of day. More days of the week. Via video call, phone call, in person, etc. The easier you are to get a hold of, the more likely people will become engaged leads to claim the free value.

4) Physical products: Make it super simple to order and fast to get to them. Make the product itself fast and easy to open. Give simple directions on how to use the product. Example: Apple made its products so well they didn't even need directions. And the packaging is so good, most people keep the boxes.

Action Step: Package your lead magnet in every way you can. It dramatically increases how many engaged leads come your way. And more leads engaging with your lead magnet means more leads getting value from it. This is huge.

Fun fact: My book *$100M Offers* has a near perfect ¼, ¼, ¼, ¼ split between ebooks, physical books, audiobooks, and videos (free on Acquisition.com). Making the book available in multiple formats is the easiest way I know to get 2-3-4x the amount of leads for the same work. If I only made it available in one format, I'd miss out on the 3-4x the people who wouldn't have read the book otherwise. What a shame that would've been and what a waste.

Step 6: Make it darn good:

Give Away The Secrets, Sell The Implementation

The marketplace judges everything you have to offer - *free or not*. And you can never provide too much value. But, you *can* provide too little. So you want your lead magnet to provide so much value people feel obligated to pay you. The goal is to provide more value than the cost of your core offer *before they've bought it.*

Think about it this way. If you're scared of giving away your secrets, imagine the alternative: You give away sucky fluff. Then, people who might've become customers think *this person sucks!*

They only have sucky fluff! Then, they buy from someone else. So sad. Not only that, they tell other folks who might've bought from you, not to. It's a vicious cycle you don't want to ride.

But remember, people buy stuff based on how much value they think they'll get *after* they buy it. And the easiest way to get them to think they'll get tons of value after they buy is… drum roll please… to provide them with value *before* they buy.

Imagine a company scaled from $1M to $10M just by consuming my free content. The chance they'll partner with Acquisition.com is huge because *I paid for my share before we even started*.

Action Step: 99% of people aren't gonna buy, but they will create (or destroy) your reputation based on the value of your free stuff. So, make your lead magnets as good as your paid stuff. Your reputation depends on it. Provide value. Stack the deck. Reap the rewards.

Step 7: Make it easy for them to tell you they want more

Once the leads consume the lead magnet, some of them will be ready to buy or learn more about your offer. This is the time to give a Call To Action. A **Call To Action (CTA)** *tells the audience what to do next.* But, there's a little more to it than that. At least, if you want your advertising to work. Good CTAs have two things: 1) what to do and 2) reasons to do it *right now.*

What to do: CTAs tell the audience to call the number, click the button, give information, book the call, etc. There are way too many to list. Just know CTAs tell the audience how to become engaged leads. Good CTAs have clear, simple, and direct language.

Not "*don't delay*" but instead "*call now.*" Read the next paragraph to learn more (see what I did there?).

Reasons to do it right now - If you give people a reason to take action, more people will do it. But a couple things to keep in mind: first, good reasons work better than bad reasons. And second, any reason (even bad ones) tends to work better than no reason at all. So to get more people to take action, I include as many effective reasons as I can. Here are my favorite reasons to act now:

a) Scarcity- Scarcity *is when there is a limited amount of something.* Especially when there is a small supply compared to demand. When something is scarce, like your lead magnet or offer, people also tend to want it more. And this is why they're more likely to act *right now*. The fewer you have, the more valuable people think it is. But there's a catch- the fewer you have, the fewer engaged leads you can get before running out. So the best strategy I know for scarcity is - *reality*. Let me explain. If you sold 1000x the customers tomorrow, could you handle it? If not, you have *some* limit to how much you can sell. Maybe you're limited by customer service, onboarding, inventory, time slots per week, etc. Don't keep it a secret - advertise it. This gives you *ethical* scarcity. If you can't handle more than five new customers per week, *say so*. Draw attention to the natural scarcity in your business. If you have limitations you may as well use them to make money.

Ex: *"The most convenient class times fill up fast. Call now to get the one you want."*

"I can only handle five people per week, so if you want it solved soon, do xyz…"

"We only printed one batch of shirts and will never reprint this design, get one so you don't regret missing out forever…"

b) Urgency. You can have unlimited units to sell, but let's say you stop selling them in an hour… *on purpose*. I bet more people than normal will buy your thing in that hour. This is urgency in action. **Urgency** *is when people act faster because they have a short amount of time.* And the less time people have, the faster (more urgent) they tend to act. So if you make the time they can act on your CTA shorter, you can get *more* of them to act on it *faster*. You can also use the same urgency with discounts or bonuses that go away after X minutes or hours. After which, this offer will never be available again.

Ex: *"Our July 4th promotion ends Monday at midnight, so if you want it, take action now."*

"Our Black Friday promotion ends at midnight. There are only four hours left. Get it while the gettin's good."

"Through Friday, I'll also throw in a free hat to anyone who buys more than three books. So if you wanna look slick in an Acquisition.com hat, buy now."

Pro Tip: The Urgency Tactic I Use The Most

I put time limits on bonuses. This way, I don't need to change my pricing or products all the time. I can just change the bonus. I like to make a handful of valuable bonuses and rotate them each week. And if they don't take action by the end of the week, they'll *actually* miss out on the bonus. The best part is that it's an *easy* way to make CTAs more effective *without capping sales.*

c) Fraternity Party Planner (my favorite) - Make Up A Reason. Fraternities don't need a reason to party - but they sure make up some doozies. "John got his wisdom teeth removed…kegger!" "Margherita Monday!" "Toga Tuesdays" "Thirsty Thursday!" etc. Your reason doesn't even have to make sense, *and it will still* get more people to act. In fact, Harvard ran an experiment showing that people were more likely to let someone cut in line *if they only gave a reason*. The number of people that let others cut *increased* if the reason made sense (like scarcity and urgency). But *any reason* still works better than *no reason*. So I always try to include one. Think 'the stuff you say' after the word *because*. Examples:

- *Because…*moms know best.
- *Because…*your country needs you.
- *Because…*it's my birthday, and I want you to celebrate with me.

Action Step: Give a clear, simple, action-oriented CTA. Then, give them a 'reason why' using scarcity, urgency, and any other reasons you can think of. And, do it often. Don't be clever, be clear.

Even if your lead magnet costs money to deliver, it should still *lower* your cost to get a new customer. This is because more engaged leads means more chances to get customers. And the extra customers *more than* cover your costs. That's the point.

Let's say you make $10,000 of profit on your core offer. And it costs you $1000 in advertising to get someone on a call for it. If you close one out of three people, it costs you $3000 in advertising to get a customer. Since we have $10,000 in profit to work with, that's fine. But we're savvy, we can do better. So, let's do better.

Imagine you advertise a free lead magnet instead of your core offer. Your lead magnet costs you $25 to deliver, and because it's free to them, more will engage. The extra engagement means it only costs $75 in advertising to get someone on a call. All in, it's $100 per call. By delivering value before they buy, *you get ten times more engaged leads for the same cost.* Note: this happens all the time when you nail the lead magnet.

Now, let's say one out of ten folks who get the lead magnet buys your core offer. This means your new cost to acquire a customer is $1000 ($100 x 10 people). We just cut our cost to get a customer by 3x. So instead of spending $3000 to get a new customer, by using a lead magnet, we spend only $1000. Given we make $10,000, that's a 10:1 return. So if we keep our advertising budget the same, and use a lead magnet, *we triple our business*. Remember: the goal is to print money, not just make our "fair share."

This is where experienced business owners beat newbies. With a $25 budget to deliver your lead magnet, you can provide FAR more value than a $0 budget. Crazy, I know. You attract more customers because your lead magnet is more valuable than other people's. Oftentimes, by a lot. This translates into more strangers becoming engaged leads. It also translates into more sales because you provided value in advance. Win. Win. Win.

Action Steps:

Step 0: If you're struggling to get leads, make an amazing lead magnet.

Step 1: Figure out the problem you want to solve for the right customer

Step 2: Figure out how you want to solve it

Step 3: Figure out how to deliver it

Step 4: Make the name interesting and clear

Step 5: Make it easy to consume

Step 6: Make sure it’s darn good

Step 7: Tell them what to do next, why it's a good idea, do it clearly, and do it often

Section II Conclusion

My goal with this book is to demystify the lead-getting process. In the first chapter, we covered why leads alone aren’t enough–you need *engaged leads*. In the second chapter, we covered how to get leads to engage - *a valuable lead magnet or offer*. And a good lead magnet does four things:

1) Engages ideal customers when they see it.
2) Gets more people to engage than your core offer alone
3) Is valuable enough that they consume it.
4) Makes the right people more likely to buy

So, more people show interest in our stuff. We make more money from them. And we deliver more value than we ever have–all at the same time.

Next Up:

We've armed ourselves with a powerful lead magnet. Now, I'll show you the four ways we can advertise it. In other words, now that we have "the stuff,"–we gotta tell people about it. Let's get some leads.

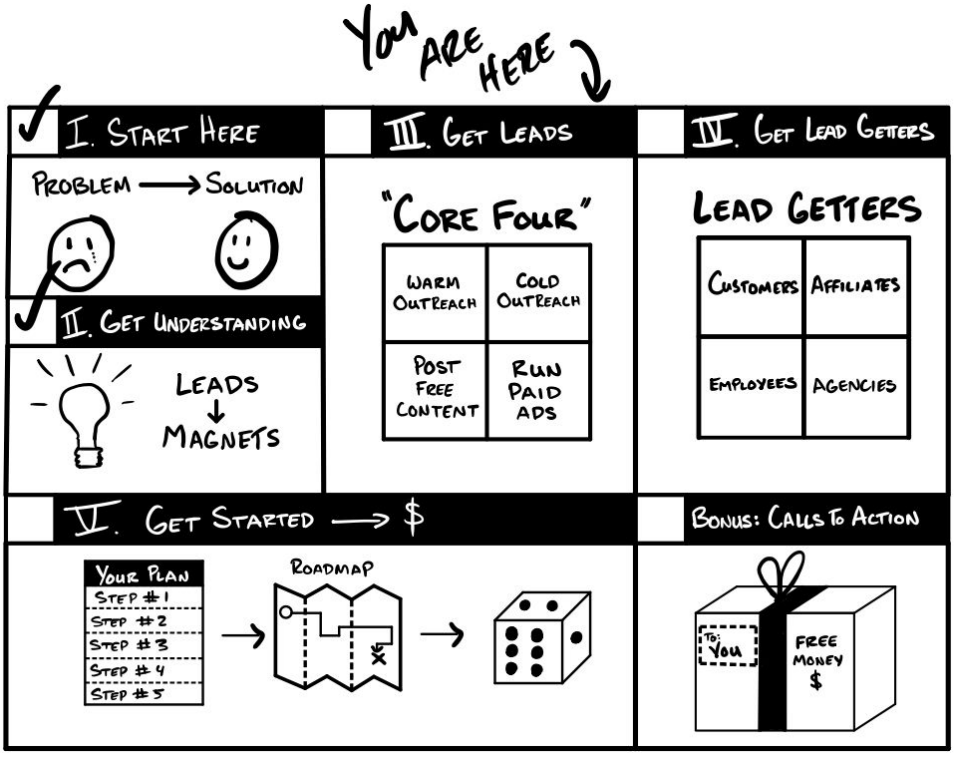
FREE GIFT: Bonus Tutorial on Making The Ultimate Lead Magnet

If you want a more in depth look at how we create insanely good lead magnets, go to **Acquisition.com/training/leads**. It's free and publicly available. As promised, my goal is to earn your trust. And trust is built brick by brick. Allow this training to be the first of many bricks. Enjoy. You can also scan the QR code below if you hate typing.



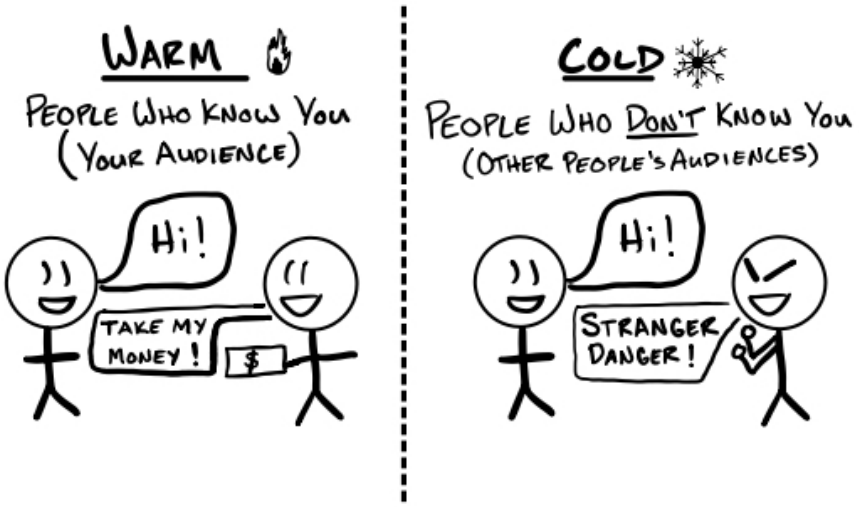
Section III: Get Leads

The Core Four Advertising Methods.



We get engaged leads by letting people know about our stuff. And there are two types of people we let know: people who know us and people who don't. And there are two paths of letting them know about it: one-to-one and one-to-many. Those combine into the four basic ways one person can let other people know about anything. Let's break down how we can use those four ways to get us leads.

Two Types of Audiences: Warm and Cold

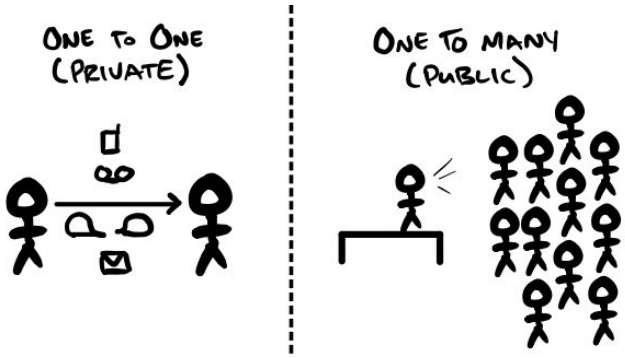


Warm audiences are *people who gave you permission to contact them.* Think “people who know you” - aka - friends, family, followers, current customers, previous customers, contacts, etc.

Cold audiences are *people who have not given you permission to contact them*. Think “strangers” - aka - other peoples’ audiences: buying contact lists, making contact lists, paying platforms for access, etc.

The difference matters because it changes *how* we advertise to them.

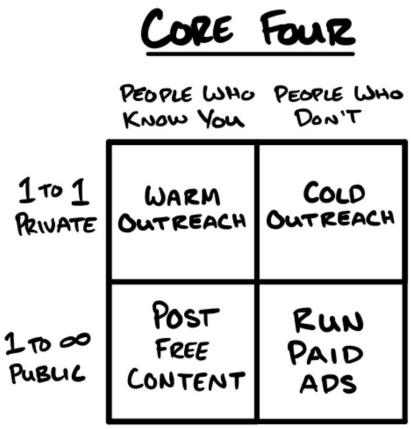
Two Ways To Communicate: One to One (Private), One to Many (Public)



We can contact people 1-to-1 or 1-to-many. Another way of thinking about this is private or public communication. Private communication is when only one person gets a message at a time. Think “phone call” or “email.” If you announce something publicly, many people can get it at the same time. Think “social media posts” or “billboards” or “podcasts.”

Now, automation can make this *seem* confusing. Don’t let it. Automation just means some of the work is done by machines. The nature of the communication stays the same. Email, for instance, is one-to-one. Emailing a 10,000 person list “once” is more like one-to-one *really fast* by a machine. Automation, which we cover later, is one of the many ways we can get leads on steroids. Like audiences, the difference between public and private communication matters because they change *how* we advertise.

Section III Outline: Get Leads



Combining warm and cold audiences with 1-to-1 and 1-to-many leads us to the only four ways we can let anyone know about anything: the core four. I combined them below for you.

- 1-to-1 to a Warm Audience = Warm Outreach
- 1-to-many to a Warm Audience = Posting Content
- 1-to-1 to a Cold Audience = Cold Outreach
- 1-to-many to a Cold Audience = Paid Ads

These are the *only* four things you can do to let other people know about the stuff you sell. And each method takes us one step closer to the land of overflowing leads. I refer to the core four throughout the rest of the book - so get to know them. In fact, make them part of yourself.

Once you do, you will have your own “get out of jail free” card to carry around forever. It will give you as many chances to succeed at business as you could ever want *for the rest of your life*. Or at least, it has for me.

So if you aren't getting as many leads as you want, you're not doing the core four with enough skill or with enough volume. We cover all this stuff in lots of detail. How they work. How to do them. When to do them. And show how to measure your progress along the way. This simplifies the overly confused world of advertising into four core ***actions***. Either do them and get as many leads as you darn well please, or get crushed by those who do.

FREE GIFT: Bonus Training - The Core Four Framework

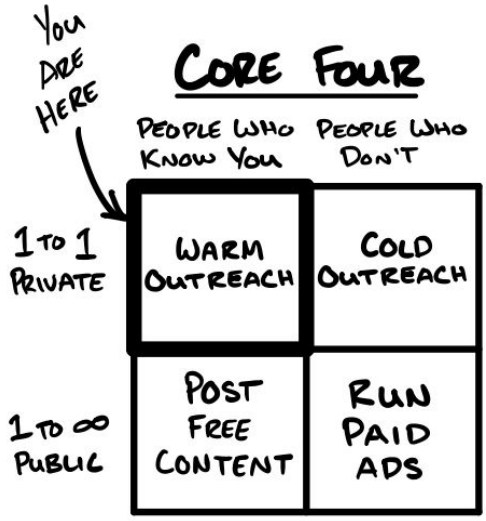
I did a live training where I explained the 50+ iterations that created this simple 2 x 2 box. I explain how to use the core four framework to get the most leads possible and create goals within your company. If you want it, you can get it fo' free here: **Acquisition.com/training/leads**. You can also scan the QR code below if you hate typing.

SCAN ME

#1 Warm Outreach

How To Reach Out To People You Know

"The world belongs to those who can keep doing without seeing the result of their doing."



May 2013. Starting out.

For the third time that day, I pulled out my phone and checked my bank account. *$51,128.13*. I let out a small sigh of relief. It's amazing how years of work and saving can fit into such a tiny screen. Feeling good for the moment, I switched over to social media to get more dopamine. Friends from college were applying to business school. Acceptance letters filled my newsfeed. I, too, started the business school application process.

I had a choice: I could either quit my job and go to business school, or I could quit my job and start a business.

The application stared at me - *How will a Harvard MBA help your short and long-term goals?*

That question changed my life. I spent three days trying to answer it. At the end of the third day, I saw the truth - *it wouldn't.* $150,000 in loans and two years without income *wouldn't* help me start a business. At least not as much as starting a business and taking two years to figure it out. *I could make the same amount by the time I graduate and skip the debt*. Or at least, that's what I told myself.

So I quit my job and took the steps to start my business. I set up Impetus Group LLC. Check. I set up a business banking account. Check. I set up a merchant account to process payments. Check. There still wasn't any money coming in, but at least I felt 'legit.'

Impetus Group LLC. (say it out loud...)

The first person I told about my new business said, "Impotence?" *God, I suck. No wonder the name was available*. I immediately changed it to 'The Free Training Project.' Name that doesn't suck? Check. I was in business.

But I had a problem - I didn't know anything about advertising or sales. But I did know I needed clients. So, I just asked around where I could. I called, texted, and sent Facebook messages to a bunch of people I knew.

"Hey, do you know anyone who's trying to get into shape? I'm training people for free for twelve weeks. On top of that, I'll make them a custom nutrition plan and grocery list. All they have to do is donate to a charity of their choice and let me use their testimonial."

Only six people said yes. Six. Two high school friends. One college friend. And three people they referred.

I emailed everyone fitness plans and we got to work. We texted during the week to keep tabs on progress. Thankfully, they were all friends of mine, so they gave it their all. They encouraged me more than anyone in the beginning. A decade later, I still have their before and after pictures.



And this is where the decision to skip business school started coming back to haunt me. A few months into this, I was less sure of myself. My ‘pile’ of money didn’t look as big without new money coming in every month. And it started turning into a real problem. So, after twelve weeks of the “pay a charity period,” I asked them to pay me instead. I was the charity now. Ha. I worried they’d be upset to pay me instead, but they didn’t seem to mind.

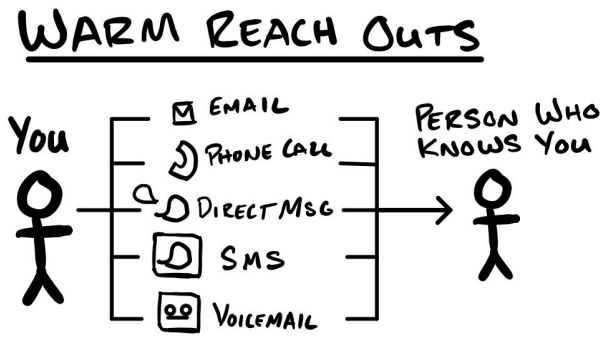
Once they got results, I asked them to send their friends over. To my surprise, I got another five or six clients from their referrals. I asked the referrals to pay me directly. Again, none of them minded. That little business made about $4000 per month and replaced the income from my first job. It gave me enough money to live on (and some). My savings started to grow again. Sigh of relief.

If this business sounds straightforward, that’s because it was. I emailed clients their plans and they texted me the questions they had along the way. That’s about it.

So if you’re starting, you don’t need a lot. All you need is a tax ID, a bank account, a way to take payments, and a way to communicate with people.

But, that last part - a way to communicate with people - is the most important part. It's how you get leads. So even though I had no idea I was doing warm reach outs, one of the *core four,* it’s how I got my first leads. I *still* get leads this way (just with bigger numbers). And I’ll show you how you can too.

How Warm Reach Outs Work



Warm reach outs are when you make one-to-one contact with your warm audience - aka - the people who know you. It's the cheapest and easiest way to find people interested in the stuff you sell. It's super effective–and most businesses don't do it. Don't be like most businesses. Also, you *do* have a warm audience, even if you don't know it. Everybody knows somebody. So your personal contacts are the easiest place to start.

Warm reach outs usually come in the form of calls, texts, emails, direct messages, voicemails, etc. And like we learned in Section II, you advertise one of two things. You let them know about your lead magnet (something free and valuable), or you let them know about your core offer (the main thing you sell).

When you start doing warm reach outs, you don't get many engaged leads for your time. You do everything on your own and make each message personal. But, for that reason, it is *reliable*. As certain as the sun rises and sets, *it works*.

Note: Reaching out to your warm audience works whether you have 100 contacts or 1,000,000. So as your business grows, you will use automation and employees to make it more efficient. The systems start small, with you, but they scale *all the way up.* I detail how to scale these systems to larger audiences in Section IV.

How To Do Warm Reach Outs in 10 Steps

Warm reach outs are a fantastic way to get your “First Five Clients” *For any new product or service.* Advanced Folks: Think re-engagement and new product lines. Here’s how to do it:

Step 1: Get your list

Step 2: Pick a platform

Step 3: Personalize your message

Step 4: Reach out

Step 5: Warm them up

Step 6: Invite their friends

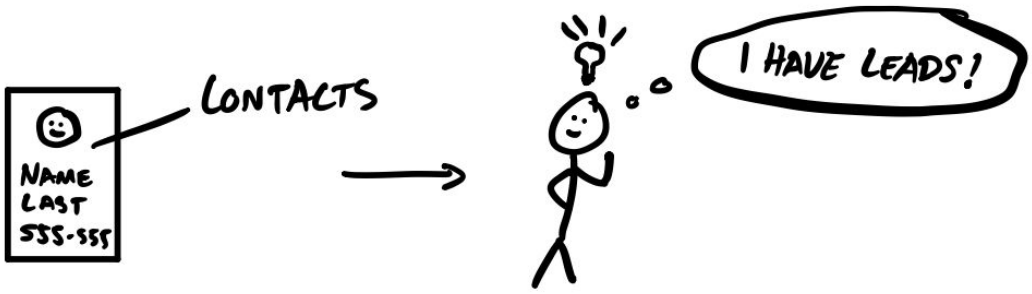
Step 7: Make them the easiest offer in the world

Step 8: Start at the top

Step 9: Start Charging

Step 10: Keep Your List Warm

(Step 1) “But I don’t have any leads…” → Everyone Has A List



You know other humans. Let me prove it to you.

- Grab your phone. Inside you have contacts. *Each contact has subscribed to communication from you*. They have given you the means *and permission* to contact them.

- Pull up *all* the email accounts you've used over the years. Pull your contacts and address list from each. Bingo! Look at all them leads.

- Now, go to all your social media profiles. See your followers, subscribers, friends, connections, or whatever kids call 'em these days...eureka – you got more leads!

Add up <u>all</u> your contacts from <u>all</u> the platforms. Seriously, *figure out the number.* Between your phone, email, social media, and other platforms you will have more than enough contacts to get started. For many of you, this will be your first 1000 leads. Would ya look at that! "I don't have any leads." Psh. Just found some.

And if you're terrified you'll have to talk to people. Relax. You'll like what I'm gonna show you next.

(Step 2) “But I don’t know where to start…” → Pick A Platform

Pick the platform you have the most contacts on. Phone, email, social media, mail, carrier pigeon, etc. It doesn’t matter. Just pick the one with the most contacts. You’ll hit ‘em all eventually anyways.

(Step 3) “But what do I say?” → Personalize your greeting

Use something you know about the contact as your actual reason to reach out. If you don’t have much personal info, you can check their social media profiles etc. to learn a bit about them first.

Don’t be a weirdo. Pay your social dues. Remember, you haven’t asked for anything. You’re just checking in and providing value. *So…relax*.

Ex: Saw you just had a baby! Congrats! How is the baby doing? How are you?

(Step 4) “Now what?” → Reach. Out. To. One. Hundred. People. Every. Day.

“To get what you want, you have to deserve what you want.” - Charlie Munger

Now, reach out to 100 of them per day with your personalized messages. You’ll call, text, email, message, send a postcard, etc.

And you will reach out to them up to three times. Once per day for three days* or until they respond. Whichever comes first.

*Once per week with physical mail.

> **Pro Tip: Rip Off The Bandaid**
>
> The first reach out is always the hardest and takes the longest. Your second reach out will take minutes. Your third, seconds. Be okay with sucking. It's new. This is how we learn. When thinking about starting new things, I remember this Chinese proverb - *"Everything must be hard before it can be easy"*

(Step 5): "What do I say when they respond?" → Act like a human.

Now we can break the ice without sounding icky.

Reply using the **A-C-A** framework:

- **A**cknowledge what they said. Restate it in your own words. This shows active listening.
    - *Ex: Two kids. And you're an accountant…*
- **C**ompliment them on whatever they tell you. Tie it to a positive character trait if you can.

- *Ex: …Wow! Supermom! So hardworking! Managing a full-time career and two kids...*

- **A**sk another question. Lead the conversation in whatever direction you want. In this case, to a topic closer to your offer. Examples:

  - Therapy/Life Coaching: …*Do you get time for yourself?*

  - Fitness/Weight Loss: ...*Do you have time to get workouts in?*

  - Cleaning Services: ...*Do you have anyone who helps you keep the house tidy?*

The **ACA** framework is great because it helps you talk to anyone. It just so happens it's *also* useful for letting people know about your stuff. This means you can learn about the person *and* guide the conversation toward your offer.

People love talking about themselves. So let them. They also love to be complimented, so do that too. And if people feel good when talking to you, they'll like and trust you more. *You want people to like and trust you more.* Besides, it's solid practice to find the good in everyone anyway. Speaking of practice, this will take practice. And that's OK.

Pro Tip: On Email You'll Be More Up Front

On email you will have a personalized opener to show that you actually took time to research them in some way. Think 2-3 sentences. Then, you will transition directly to your offer or lead magnet which we talk about next. You sort of 'do it all at once' with email or voicemails.

(Step 6) "How do I know if they're interested?" → Make them an offer.

Get through a 'normal' amount of conversation. Think 3-4 exchanges if on the phone or messaging and 3-4 minutes if in person. Then, you'll make them an offer to see if they're interested.

When I make an offer from scratch, I refer to the value equation. If you're wondering 'what's the value equation?' - it was the core concept of my first book *$100M Offers.* Value, as I define it, has four elements:



1) Dream Outcome: what the person wants to happen, the way they want it to happen

- State the best possible results your product can get. Big bonus points if those results come from people like the one you're talking to.

2) Perceived Likelihood of Achievement: how likely they think it is for them to achieve their goal

- Include results, reviews, awards, endorsements, certifications, and other forms of *3rd party validation.* Also, guarantees are huge.

3) Time Delay: how long they believe it'll take to get results after they buy

- Describe how fast people *start* getting results, how often they get results when they start, and how long it takes to get the best results possible.

4) Effort and Sacrifice: The bad stuff they'll have to endure and the good stuff they'll have to give up in their struggle to get the result.

- Show them the good stuff they can keep doing, or get to do, and still get results. And show them the bad stuff that they can get rid of, or avoid doing, and still get results.

The goal is to maximize the first two and minimize the second two. So all you have to do now is show someone:

- You have exactly what they want

- They’re guaranteed to get it
- Insanely fast
- Without lifting a finger or giving up anything they love

No biggie, right? Obviously, that’s ideal. We gotta get as close to that as we can without lying or exaggerating.

So let’s do just that with a real-life offer:

...By the way, do you know anybody who is (describe their struggles) *looking to* (dream outcome) *in* (time delay)*? I’m taking on five case studies for free, because that’s all I can handle. I just want to get some testimonials for my service/product. I help them* (dream outcome) *without* (effort and sacrifice). *It works. I even guarantee people get* (dream outcome) *or I work with them until they do. I just had a girl named XXX work with me* (dream outcome) *even though she* (describe the same struggle your contact has). *I also had another guy who* (dream outcome) *and it was his first time. I’d just like more testimonials to show it works across different scenarios. Does anyone you like come to mind?* (Pause if on the phone) …and if they say no…*Haha, well…does anyone you hate come to mind?* (ha) This helps break any awkwardness.

Pro Tip: Implied Perceived Likelihood of Achievement

You'll notice *besides the guarantee*, there's no slot for "perceived likelihood of achievement." But how we explain the testimonials fulfills that need. After all, we're not gonna say "hey! I can obviously help you because I've helped someone *exactly* like you." But we *imply* that by selecting a testimonial that's as close to their situation as possible. And the longer you are in business, the more 'perfect fit' testimonials you'll have. So the easier it'll be to show testimonials that *perfectly* match the person you're speaking with. Then, once you can show *one* perfect testimonial, the only thing better is *a buttload of them*.

There's an important feature here. *We're not asking them to buy anything. We're asking if they know anyone.* And of the people who say yes, most say *they* are interested. This entire thing is engineered to boost *their* perceived likelihood of achievement. It's why we show struggles *and* results from people like them who have struggles like theirs. But, we let *them* connect the dots. Since you didn't ask them to buy anything, you don't come off as pushy. Some people will show interest in your stuff. Some will refer you to those who might. Some will do both. In all three outcomes, you win. And you win *without pushing anything on anyone.*

If you have even less time or space to deliver it, just use the value elements back to back:

I help (ideal customer) *get* (dream outcome) *in* (time period) *without* (effort and sacrifice) *and* (increase perceived likelihood of achievement–look at the pro tip below).

Note: These work well for emails, texts, direct messages, calls, and in-person. Just fill in the blanks.

Pro Tip: 11 Ways To Increase Perceived Likelihood of Achievement

Here's how you increase their perceived likelihood of achievement so more people take you up on your offer. Include one or more of the following:

1. Showing proof we have done what they want (our own story)
2. Showing proof of people *just like them* getting what they want (think testimonials)
3. Showing the sheer volume of happy reviews we've received (think lots of 5-stars)
    a. If you don't have reviews yet, even the number of people you've helped works.
4. Certifications/Degrees/Third party accreditations that we're legit
5. Numbers, stats, research that supports the outcome you want them to believe

Pro Tip: 11 Ways To Increase Perceived Likelihood of Achievement (Contd.)

6. Experts vouching for us

7. Some new/unique characteristic they haven't failed with before (so it might work this time)

8. Celebrities who have endorsed us ('they trusted them, so should I')

9. Guaranteeing they'll achieve it (so we put some skin in the game too)

10. How well you describe them or the current pain they're experiencing. The more specific the better. (think 'he/she really gets me, they must know how to help')

11. If possible, demonstrate the outcome live. Or, show a recording of it happening.
    a. Ex: Advertising agency plays a recording of a call that a gym owner has to make to a lead on the sales call. "Could you handle making a call like that to a lead if we get them for you?" It demonstrates the outcome of the advertising services - people don't want "leads" they want customers. They just don't know a better way to ask for them.

(Step 7) "How do I get them to say yes?" → Make it easy for them to say yes. Make it free.



After people show interest, make your offer easy to say yes to. I like to start with the easiest offer enhancer in the world - FREE:

And don't try to look advanced if you're not. People aren't dumb. Just be honest and keep it simple:

Since I'm only taking on five people, I can give you all the attention you need to get brag-worthy results. And I'll give it all for free so long as you promise to: 1) Use it 2) Give me feedback and 3) Leave a killer review if you think it deserves one. Does that sound fair?

This sets reasonable expectations upfront. And boom. Now, you're just helping people for free. Winning.

Pro Tip: Stack "Yeses" To Build Early Momentum.

Early on, I felt terrified asking for money. So, if you recall from the story above, I told people I would work with them for free as long as they donated to a charity of their choice. I still got them invested in their results, but asking them for a feelgood tax write-off felt like a much safer way to do it. By the way, this was the first thing I ever sold. Looking back, I wanted easy low pressure YESES under my belt. And those early yeses built my first business. And they can build your business too.

My recommendation - whenever you launch a new product or service - make the first five free. The exact number matters less than knowing why you benefit from it. Here's why:

1. You get the reps in and become comfortable with making offers to people. It'll calm your nerves knowing you're just helping… for free…for now (winky face).

2. You probably suck (for now). People are far more forgiving when you haven't charged anything.

3. Because you probably suck, you need to learn how to suck less. You suck less by doing more. It's better to have a few guinea pigs to get the kinks out. You'll learn a ton from the people you help for free, I promise. Even though it may not feel like it now, you're getting the better end of the deal.

4. If people get value, especially for free, they're far more likely to:

a. Leave positive reviews and testimonials.

b. Give you feedback.

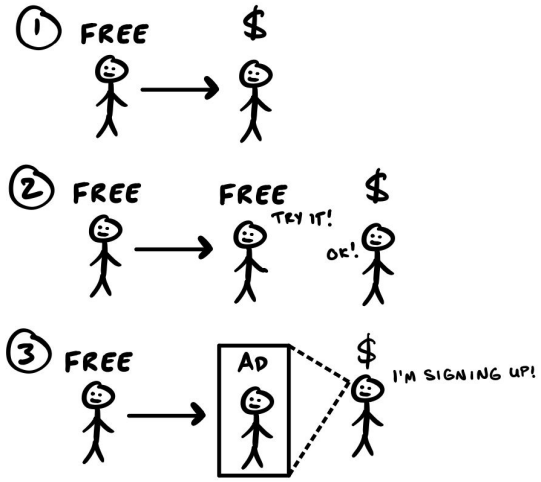
c. Send their friends and family.

And if that’s not awesome enough, free customers can make you money in three other ways:

1) They convert into paying customers.

2) They send you paying customers via referrals.

3) Their testimonials bring in paying customers.



So no matter what, you win.

Pro Tip: Apply the "Hinge Method" to Referrals

If you ask for a referral, get a three-way introduction. My favorite way to do this in person is to grab the customer's phone, take a picture of the two of us, then text that picture to the referral and your own number. If I'm virtual, screenshot a video call and do the same thing. If you can't do that, then at least get a three way conversation going with *them* initiating it.

What if they say no?

Often, the most expensive part of what you sell isn't the price–it's the hidden costs. **Hidden costs** are the time, effort, and sacrifice it takes to get results from the thing you sell. In other words, the bottom part of the value equation. If you struggle to give your stuff away for free, it means either people don't want it (dream outcome), they don't believe you (perceived likelihood of achievement) *or* the hidden costs (time, effort and sacrifice) are too high. In short, your 'free' stuff is *too expensive*. So figure out the hidden costs. Once you do, you unlock even more value–that you'll eventually be able to charge for.

To build your understanding of hidden costs… *ask.* So when someone says "no" ask "why?":

"What would I have to do to make it worth it for you to continue?"

Their answers give you a chance to solve their problem. And if you solve that problem, they'll probably buy from you. And even if

they don’t buy from you, they’ll give you the ammo to get the next person to.

And remember, failure is a requisite for success. It’s part of the process. So rack up failures as fast as you can. Get them out of the way to start paying down your “no tax.” If you get thousands of nos, you will get your yeses, I promise. I always tell myself: Yeses give me opportunity. Nos give me feedback. Either way, I win.

Author Note: Warren Buffet and Benjamin Graham

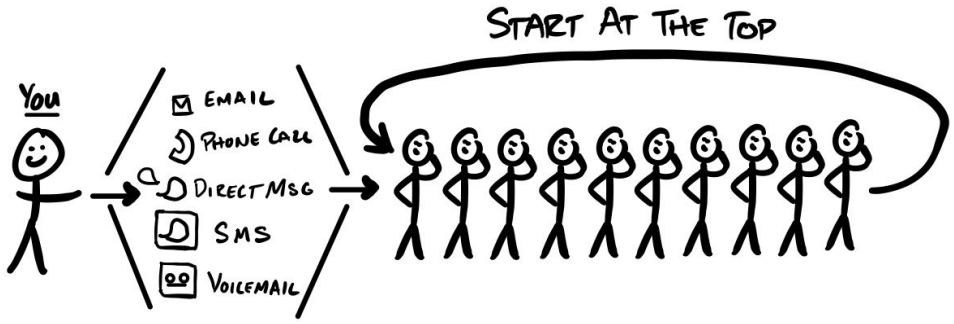
Before Warren Buffet became the greatest investor of our time, he offered to work for his hero, Ben Graham, for free. Wanna know Graham’s response? “You’re overpriced.” Graham knew what was up. The most expensive thing about hiring Buffet wasn’t a paycheck, but the time to train him. Graham would actually be working for Buffet! And in the same way, your early customers are working for you. They’re training you - for free! And you want to minimize that cost to them. *Know your hidden costs.*

PS - Buffet still managed to get Graham to take his free offer. The rest is history.

Pro Tip: Learning or Earning

If anyone tells you not to “undervalue yourself” by giving your services away for free in the beginning, tell them to hush. Sure, you’re a special snowflake. But the stuff you sell isn’t. It isn’t valuable *yet*. You’ve barely started. The objective right now is to *learn* not to *earn*. We’ll get to the earning once we’ve learned more. But we must crawl before we run. Don’t get the objectives mixed. The earning will come, *I promise*.

(Step 8) “What Do I Do Once I’ve Reached Out To Everyone?” → Start Back At The Top



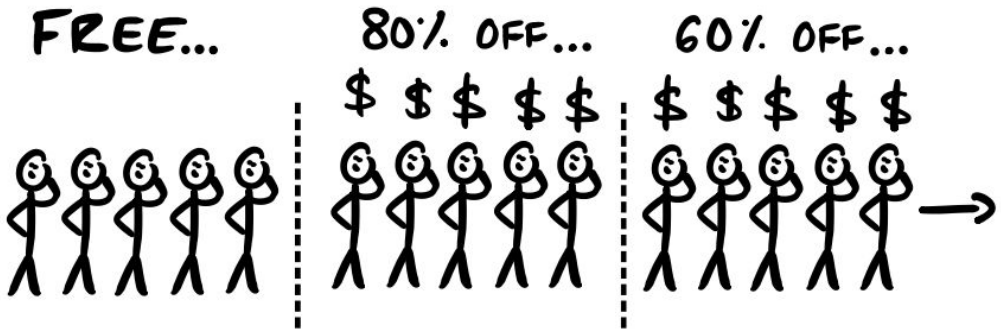
After reaching out to all the leads on one platform, switch to the platform you have the second most leads on. After you reach out to those leads, go to the platform you have the third most leads on and so forth.

Let’s say you follow this to the tee because being poor sucks more than helping people for free. If between all platforms, you have 1000 leads, that gives you ten solid days of work. A month of work

including follow-ups. By this point, I promise, *five or more people will have accepted your free offer.* And some will have converted into paying customers. If you did a good job, they'll send friends, and they'll become paying customers too.

So, let's make our first dollar.

(Step 9) "But I can't work for free forever…" → Start Charging.



This is important. This is your litmus test to know when you're "good enough" to charge. *Once people start referring, start charging.* When that happens, swap out '*… free…'* in the script above to '*80% off* for the next five'. Then '*60% off* for the next five.' Then '*40% off* for the next five,' and so forth. The "I increase my prices every five" rule also adds urgency because prices *actually* go up. And if you're curious, you don't have to stop raising your price. Feel free to keep raising it by 20% every five until you find your sweet spot. It's your business. You can do what you want. Charge more as you get more experienced - a nice reward.

Pro Tip: Get More Cash Up Front & More Yeses → Prepay + Guarantee

Offering a guarantee gets more people to buy because it reverses risk. Here's a nice twist on a guarantee that'll get you more yeses *and* more cash.

You can offer a guarantee only to people who pay up front. Reason why: *People who invest up front are more committed. And as a result, we're able to guarantee their outcomes. So if you'd like our guarantee, you can prepay our service.*

Another version of wording I got my good friend Dr. Kashey: After the person agrees to buy, you say *"would you rather pay less today or get all your money back?"* Paying less today = payment plan, so less money down. Get all your money back = prepay and get a guarantee that you get the result you want.

Ex: "Pay Less" = $2000/mo for 3 months = $6000 (no guarantee)

Or

"Get All Your Money Back" = $6000 up front *with* a guarantee.

Presented this way, the majority of the people take the up front cash option with the guarantee. So if you planned on offering one anyways, you may as well weaponize it to incentivize more people to pay up front.

(Step 10) "But what do I do from here?" →Keep your list warm.

Give regular value to your list through email, social media, etc. to keep it warm. A warm list stays primed for your warm reach outs in the future. We cover exactly how to give that value in the next chapter. Once you've given value for a while, or see who wants value, probe your list with Dean Jackson's timeless "9-word email" template":

Are you still looking to [4 word desire]?

No images. No frills. No links. Just a question. Nothing else. This message is money for getting leads to engage. And it's among the first things I do when I invest in a new business. Here are a few examples:

Are you still looking to

…buy your dream home?

…get more sales leads?

…tone up your arms?

…open an online store?

…start a YouTube channel?

You get the idea. Swipe and deploy. You make the ask to see who replies - aka - engaged leads. And *these replies should be your top priority for warm reach outs.*

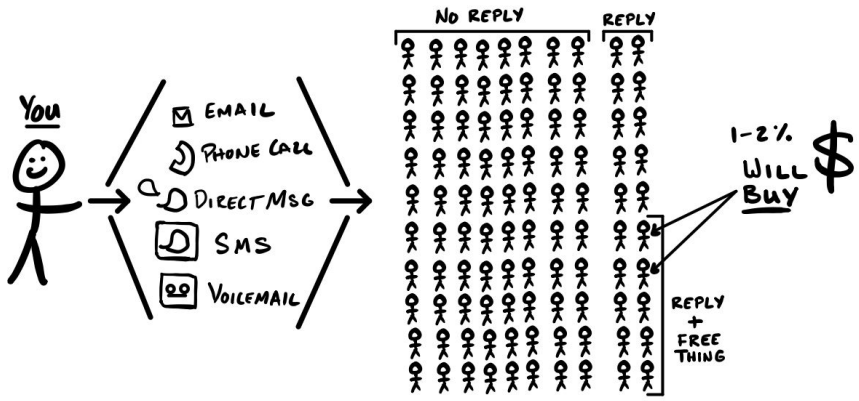
I'll end step 10 here because I break down this "give-ask" process in the next chapter. The main point is that a warm list is a huge asset because it's a consistent and *growing* source of engaged leads. If you treat them well, your audience will feed you forever.

Advertising Checklist Summary

Now let's look at this in ten lines because it took ten pages to get here.

Warm Reach Outs Daily Checklist	
Who:	Yourself
What:	First five free
Where:	Phone/Email/Physical Mail/SMS/Etc
To Whom:	Your Contacts
When:	First four hours of your day
Why:	You want to get customers or intros
How:	Personalized Message using ACA
How Much:	100 Attempts Per Day
How Many:	Follow up two more times after first.
How Long:	Until you get customers

Benchmarks: How well am I doing?



Warm reach outs should get about one in five contacts to engage. So one hundred warm reach outs should get about twenty replies. Of the twenty who reply, another one in five*ish* will take you up on your free offer. So, four people. Of the four who take your free offer now, you should be able to convert *one* into some sort of paid offer later. Hooray - money.

This framework allows you to predict how many customers you get per 100 warm reach outs. In the example, you would get one customer per 100 reach outs. These numbers vary based on the value of your offer and how much they trust you. But, no matter what, with enough volume, *you will get a customer*. And the more you do it, the better your numbers will get. It just takes effort. You'll also learn a lot about what engages your audience: what they value and how to make offers to them. This knowledge can make you millions. You get to learn while you earn - score.

This process *alone* can take you to $100,000+ per year with nothing else. Wild, I know. Here's the money math:

This assumes 1% of your list buys a $400 offer using *only* warm reach outs.

500 reach outs per week = 5 customers per week

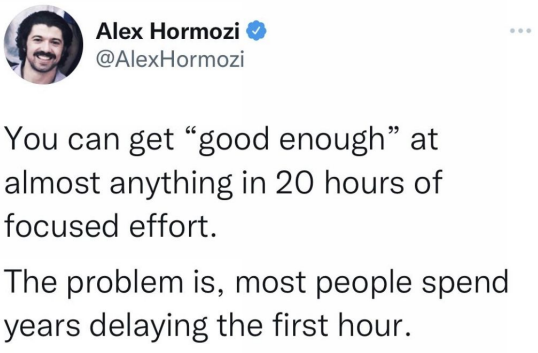
$400 product → 5 customers per week x $400 each = $2000/wk

$2000/wk x 52 weeks = $104,000…bingo.

Which, as of this writing, is still two times the median household income in the US. Not bad.

Pro Tip: Join Communities

To learn even faster, join communities of people doing the same advertising method as you. They're great for peer support and up-to-date tricks and tips. Also - don't do anything sketchy. There are lots of people who pride themselves on pushing the legal envelope. Don't be that person. It always comes back to bite you. Do it the right way and you will feed yourself for life.



You'll learn more in the first ten days of *doing* 100 reach outs than you did from everything you've ever read or watched. Get that

learning done as fast as you can. Remember, *we want to get rich, not just "get by."*

What's Next?

Warm reach outs have two limitations.

The first is time. When you're starting out, getting new customers should take the majority of your time. Think four hours per day, minimum. It should be the first thing you do when you get up. And you shouldn't stop until you achieve your goal. Embrace the work. It will be part of the story you tell one day. It has been for me.

The second limiter is the number of people who know you. You'll eventually "run out." Don't worry though. We can get more. A lot more. Now we *add* the second of the core four advertising activities: posting free content.

FREE GIFT: Bonus Training - Warm Reach Outs

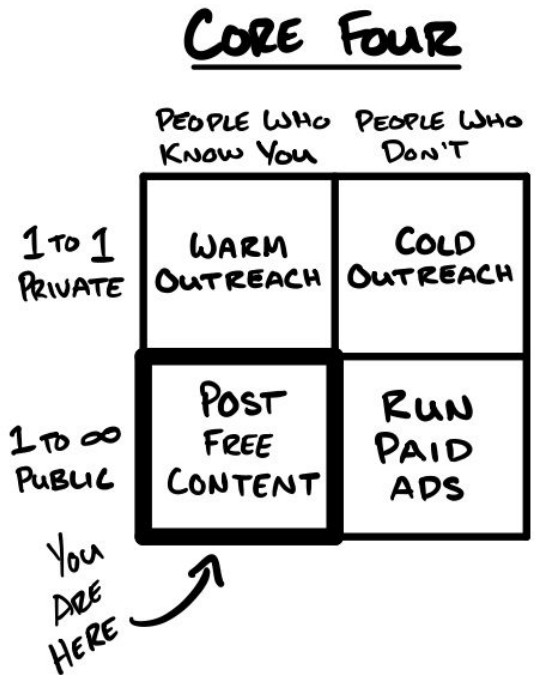
If you like this stuff, I go deeper in a no-holds-barred breakdown of the many different strategies you can use within warm reach outs to get your first or zillionth customer. If that sounds cool, go to **Acquisition.com/training/leads**. And, if you needed another reason, it's free. I hope you use it to get as many leads as you need. You can also scan the QR code below if you hate typing.


SCAN ME

#2 Post Free Content Part I

How To Build An Audience To Get Engaged Leads

No one's ever complained about getting too much value.



January 2020

"Did you hear about Kylie Jenner?" Leila asked.

"No, why?" I replied.

"She's now the youngest female self-made billionaire."

"Wait, what?"

“Yea, she’s twenty. Forbes just put her on the cover.”

I was ten years older than her and *not* a billionaire. *Why do I suck so much?* How could she make so much more than me? I thought I was pretty good at business–we took home $13M in personal income the year before. But, I was clearly missing something. And I felt horrible about it.

My ego protected me… *Well, Kris Jenner is her mother and she must have organized all this.* I wrote it off as “rich parents” and moved on.

A few months later…

Leila looked up from her computer.

“Dude - Huda just sold a minority stake in her company at a $600M valuation.”

“Huda, the makeup girl?” I replied.

“Yea.”

“Holy cow.” *Again? How have I been screwing up so bad?* How was someone so young making so much more money than me?

…She’s in beauty, she can do that, I can’t. I told myself, then carried on.

A few months later…

A headline caught my eye:

"Conor McGregor's Proper 12 whiskey hits a $600M valuation within 12 months of launching."

Seriously!? - *Another* person making gobs of money in what felt like seconds.

A few months later…

I saw another headline. *"With an Insane $3.5 Billion Worth, Dwayne Johnson's 'Teremana' Sweeps the Floor With Conor McGregor's 'Proper 12'."*

Dwayne "The Rock" Johnson was now a multi-billionaire. And he never even talked about business! *What am I doing wrong?*



A few months later… at a famous friend's house…

Up to this point, I stayed behind the scenes for the most part. I did not want to be famous. I wanted to be rich. And I succeeded at that.

But seeing these successes chipped away at my beliefs. Could building a personal brand be *that* powerful? Simple answer - yes. But, I wanted my privacy…

We sat around his kitchen table, and I asked him, “You get all these weird messages from strangers. People threaten your family. Are you still happy you became famous?” He replied with something that changed my life forever:

“If getting weird messages and hate from people I don't know is the price I have to pay to make the impact I want to have, I’d pay that price any day of the week.”

I felt exposed. I was being a pansy. I claimed I wanted to make the impact, but wasn’t willing to pay the price for it. After that conversation, Leila and I went all in on building personal brands.

***

I have a core belief I’d like to transfer to you. <u>If someone is making more money than you, they are better at the game of business in some way.</u> Take it as good news. It means you can learn from them. Don’t think they had it easy. Don’t think they had a shortcut. Don’t tell yourself they broke some moral code. Even if it’s true, none of those beliefs serve you. None of those beliefs *make you better.*

Years ago, I was vocal about “making content.” I didn’t see the point. Why would I waste my time making something that would disappear in a few days? I thought it was a stupid waste of time and let everyone know. I was wrong. It really wasn’t about the content at all - it was about the audience. What I didn’t understand was - the content you create isn’t the compounding asset - <u>*the audience is*</u>. So even though the content may disappear in time, your audience keeps growing.

This was a lesson my ego prevented me from learning for too long. It took an entire year of getting hit in the face with solid evidence before I changed my ways. *Building an audience is the most valuable thing I've ever done.*

I saw Kylie Jenner, Huda Kattan, Connor McGregor, and The Rock become billionaires "overnight." My famous friend said a massive audience was crucial to his success. The overwhelming evidence broke my beliefs, so I rewrote them. I now saw the power of having an audience. But, I didn't know where to start. So, I did what I always do. *I paid for knowledge.* Buying somebody else's experience saves the time it would take to figure everything out yourself. Leila bought me four calls with a big influencer who had the type of audience I wanted to build. She paid $120,000.

On my first call, he told me to post regularly on every platform. So, that's what I did. Twelve months later, my audience grew by more than 200,000 people. On my second call, he noted the progress. But I wanted more, "Do you have a blueprint for your personal branding? How do you put out all that content?"

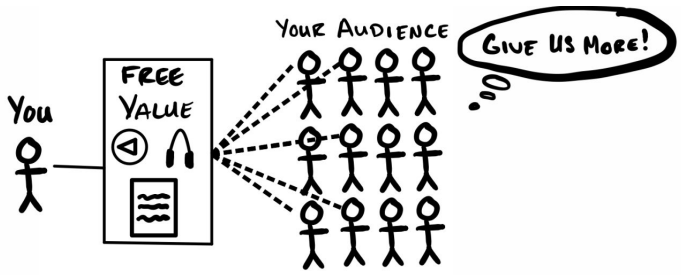
He said, "Bro, anyone telling you there's some secret is trying to sell you something. We just put out as much as we possibly can. Pull up your Instagram and pull up my Instagram... Look. You've posted once today. I posted three times. Pull up your LinkedIn… Look. You posted once this week. I posted five times *today*." He went platform by platform. I grew more embarrassed with each comparison.

"You just gotta do more bro."

Simple. Not easy. Over the next six months I put out *ten times* the content. And over the next six months, I added 1.2M people to my audience. Also, when I put out ten times the content, my audience

grew ten times as fast. Volume works. Content works. A growing audience is the result. And in this chapter, I'll break down how I did it so you can too.

How Building An Audience Works - You Post Great Free Content



Warm reach outs don't get a lot of engaged leads for the time we invest. If we want to reach ten people, we have to repeat ourselves ten times. Lots of effort. By posting free content, we can say it once and reach all ten. So, posting free content can get a lot more engaged leads for the time we invest. Hooray.

The people who think it's valuable become part of your warm audience. If they think other people will find it valuable, they share it. And if the people they share it with like it, they become part of your warm audience too. Rinse and repeat. The sharing can go on infinitely. The more they share your stuff, the larger your warm audience gets. And once in a while, you'll make them an offer. If your offer has enough value, they'll take it. When they do, you make money. And the bigger the audience, the more money you make. Look at it this way:

- Posting free content grows your warm audience.

- So constantly posting free content means you'll have a constantly growing audience of people more likely to buy your stuff.

- Free content makes all other advertising more effective. If you reach out to someone and they can't find content related to your services, they're less likely to buy. On the other hand, if they find lots of valuable content, they are more likely to buy.

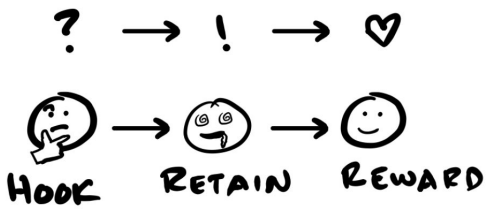
This is what my ego prevented me from learning. Now the headlines with Jenner, Huda, McGregor, and The Rock all made perfect sense.

But, posting free content is not all sunshine and rainbows. It has trade-offs. First, it is more difficult to personalize your message. So fewer people respond. Second, you compete with everyone else posting free content. This makes it harder to stand out. Third, if you do stand out, people will copy you. This means you need to constantly innovate.

That being said - A bigger audience means more engaged leads. More engaged leads means more money. More money means you more happy. Just kidding - it won't do that. But it'll give you the resources to remove stuff you hate. Anyways…

This chapter covers only two topics. First, we demystify audience-growing content by showing it's all made of the same basic units. A content unit has three components - Hook, retain, and reward. Second, how linking basic units together will make audience-growing content for any platform or media type. The next chapter (Post Free Content Part II) shows you how to weaponize this content to make money. But for now, you can't monetize content until you know how to make it.

The Content Unit - Three Components



All audience-growing content does one thing - it rewards the people consuming it. And a person can only get rewarded by the content if they:

1) Have a reason to consume it and

2) Pay attention long enough to

3) Get that reason satisfied.

Thankfully, we can reverse those three outcomes into the three things we have to *do* to make audience-growing content. This means we have to:

a) **Hook** attention: get them to notice your content.

b) **Retain** attention: get them to consume it.

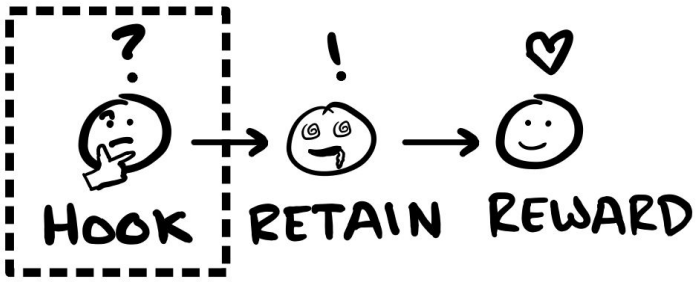
c) **Reward** attention: satisfy the reason they consumed it to begin with.

The smallest amount of material it takes to hook, retain and reward attention is a **content unit**. It can be as little as an image, a meme, or a sentence. Meaning, you can hook, retain, and reward *at the same time*. This is how short tweets, meme images, or even a jingle can go

viral. They do all three. I separate them so we can discuss them more clearly, but they can all happen at once.

Let’s dive into each of the things we do to create a content unit. This way you can create effective content that grows your audience.

1) Hook: They cannot be rewarded unless we first get their attention.



The objective: We give them a reason to redirect their attention from whatever they are doing towards us. If we do that, we’ve hooked them. The effectiveness of your hook is measured by the percentage of people who start consuming your content. So if you hook attention well, *many* people will have a reason to consume your content. If you do a poor job, *few* people will have a reason to consume your content. Remember, this is a competition for attention. We have to beat every alternative they have to win theirs. Make yourself the best option.

We increase the percentage of people who pick our content by picking *topics* they find interesting, *headlines* that give them a reason, and matching the *format* of other stuff they like. Let’s dive into each.

Topics. Topics are the things you make your content about. I prefer to use personal experiences. Here’s why: there’s only one of you.

The easiest way to differentiate is to say something no one else can say. And no one else has lived your life but you. I divide topics into five categories: Far Past, Recent Past, Present, Trending, and Manufactured.

a) Far Past: The important *past* lessons in your life. Connect that wisdom to your product or service to provide huge value to your audience. Give them the story without the scar. *It's why I write these books*.

    i) Example: A personal lesson where I broke my belief that "I don't have enough time":

        1) Hook: I complained to a friend that I didn't have enough time to do something *while glued to my phone.*

        2) Retain: They yanked it out of my hands and looked at its usage. It showed I spent three hours *per day* on social media.

        3) Reward: They looked back at me and said, "Hey, I found you some time."

        It's a simple story other people can relate to. This makes it an interesting topic to more people. And it connects what I do, growing businesses, to a struggle many people experience - not having enough time. The epiphany I give away makes this lesson valuable for *my audience* – people starting, growing, and selling their businesses.

b) Recent Past: Do stuff, then talk about what you did (or what happened). Any time you speak with somebody, there's a chance your audience can get value from it. Look at your calendar for the last week. Look at all your meetings. Look at all your social

interactions. Look at all your conversations with warm reach outs. *There's gold in these conversations*. Tell stories from them that would serve your audience. For example:



i) This tweet came from a meeting I had with a portfolio CEO that was just copying the same offer everyone else in his market was making and was getting subpar results.

ii) This means taking notes, recordings, and other records to make that stuff easy to access. But it also means a free, easy, and valuable stash of content.

iii) Testimonials and case studies fall in this category. If you can tell a cool client story *in a way that provides value to your audience*, you'll both promote your services and provide value. Win-win.

c) <u>Present</u>: Write down ideas *at the exact time they come to you*. Always have a way to record your ideas in arms reach. I'll even pause meetings to make note of, text, or email ideas to myself. People don't mind when you ask to take notes anyway, so it's not weird. Then, when you make content, you have a bucket of fresh stories to work with.

i) *I note my ideas publicly:* I used to keep ideas to myself. Now, I tweet them publicly as they happen. If a post does better than normal, I know it's something people find interesting. Then, I make more stuff on that topic.

d) Trending: Go where the attention is. Look at what's trending right now and make stuff about it. Apply your own experiences to it. If you have relevant commentary or it touches your expertise in some way, talk about it. Talking about trendy stuff is very effective for gaining the attention of a broader audience.

e) Manufactured: Turn your ideas into reality. Pick a topic people find interesting. Then, learn about it, make it, or do it. Then, show it to the world. This costs the most time and effort since you have to create the experience versus talking about one you already had. But, it can have the biggest payouts.

    i) Example manufactured experience: *I lived on $100 for a month. Here's how.* Now I don't live that way, but I could manufacture that experience then make content about it.

Author Note: Manufactured vs Documenting

Manufactured content has the most potential to grow and monetize an audience, *by far*. This is because skilled content creators can engineer the maximum reward for every content unit. To give you an idea, as of this writing, the top ten videos on the most popular video platform are all music videos. And they've racked up about 60 *billion* views. Watching or listening- that's *a lot* of attention! But for us mortals, the lower cost of documenting our experiences (versus manufacturing them) lets us keep the volume high. And - I believe it's more sustainable over a lifetime. A quote I heard from a famous content creator "I don't want to be filling my living room with sand when I'm fifty." And, personally, I'd rather see entrepreneurs put out more content, more often, and in more places. Just one man's 2 cents.

Action Step: Life happens–profit by sharing yours.

Headlines. A headline is a short phrase or sentence used to grab the audience's attention. It communicates the reason they should consume the content. They use it to weigh the likelihood they will get a reward for consuming your content versus another.

Rather than give you a bunch of templates, I'd rather give you the timeless principles that make great headlines. And, there's no greater headline creator than "the news." So let's study them.

A meta-analysis of news revealed headline components that drove the most interest in stories. They are as follows. Try and include at least two in your headline.

a. Recency - As recent as possible, quite literally the ‘new’s

    i. Example: People pay attention to something that happened an hour ago more than a year ago.

b. Relevancy - Personally meaningful

    i. Example: Nurses pay more attention to stuff that affects nurses compared to stuff that affects accountants.

c. Celebrity - Including prominent people (celebrities, authorities, etc.).

    i. Example: Normally, we wouldn’t care what another human has for breakfast every day. But if it’s Jeff Bezos, we do. Since he’s a celebrity, many people care.

d. Proximity - Close to home – geographically

    i. Example: A house on fire across the country doesn’t get your attention. If it’s your neighbor, it sure does. Make it as close to home as possible.

e. Conflict - of opposing ideas, opposing people, nature, etc.

    i. Example: Pineapple vs no Pineapple on pizza? Conflict!

    ii. Example: Good vs Evil. Hero vs Villain. Left vs Right.

    iii. Example: Freedom vs Security. Justice vs Mercy. You get the idea.

f. Unusual - odd, unique, rare, bizarre

    i. Example: Think of a six-fingered man at the old-time circuses. If it's outside of the norm, people pay more attention.

g. Ongoing - Stories still in progress are dynamic, evolving, and have plot twists.

    i. Example: If someone goes into labor, people want updates every ten minutes because *anything could happen*.

Action Step: Include one or more of these components to give yourself meatier, attention-grabbing headlines.

Format. Once we have a good topic and communicate it with a headline using one or more components, we need to match our format to the best content on the platform. People consume content because it's similar to stuff they've liked in the past. And matching the popular format of the platform gets the most people to interact with it. So, we want to make our content look like the stuff they've liked before.

Format example:



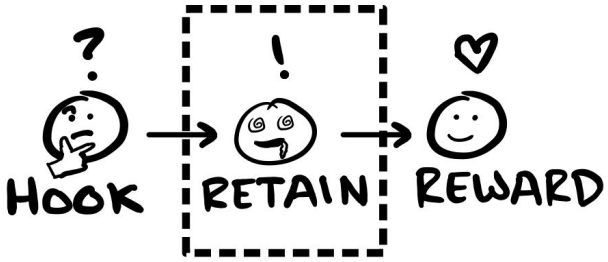
This meme communicates the point better than I can with words. All four images above are…well…images. But, they have a different look and feel. This is because formatting depends on the audience you want to hook *and* the platform your audience is on.

Bottom Line: You've gotta make your content look like *what they expect will reward them.* Otherwise, no matter how good it is, better-looking content will hook them before yours even has a chance.

Action Step: Format your content for the platform first. Then, tweak it so it hooks your ideal audience. Use the best content on the platform that targets your market as your guide.

This concludes the "hook" step of our content unit. *Always* following these basics will already put you in the top 1%. At least, it has for me.

2) Retain



My favorite driver of retention is *curiosity*. It's my favorite because, if done correctly, people will wait *years.* People want to know what happens…*next*. For example, I get messages daily, for years now, about when I will release a book on sales.

My favorite way to get the audience curious is to embed questions in their minds. Unresolved questions can be explicit or implicit. You can directly ask the question. Or, the question can be implied. My three favorite ways to embed questions are: lists, steps, and stories.



a) <u>Lists</u>: Lists are things, facts, tips, opinions, ideas, etc. presented one after the other. Good lists in free content also follow a theme. Think "Top 10 Mistakes" or "5 Biggest Money Makers" and so on. Giving the number of listed items in your headline, or in the first few seconds of your content, tells people what to expect. And in my experience, this retains more of the audience's attention for longer.

i) Example: “7 Ways I invested $1000 in my 20s That Paid Off Big”

ii) Example: “28 Ways To Stay Poor”

iii) Example: “A content unit has three pieces…”,

b) Steps: Steps are actions that occur in order and accomplish a goal when completed. Provided the early steps were clear and valuable, the person will want to know how to do them all to accomplish the overall goal.

i) Example: “3 Steps to Creating a Great Hook”

ii) Example: “How I Create a Headline in 7 Steps”

iii) Example: “The Morning Routine That Boosts My Productivity”

Note: Here’s the difference between steps and lists. Steps are *actions* that must be done in a *specific order* to get a result. So steps are less flexible but have a more explicit reward. Lists can have just about anything on them in any order you want. So lists are more flexible but have a less explicit reward.

c) Stories: Stories describe events, real or imaginary. And stories worth telling often have some lesson or takeaway for the listener. You can tell stories about things that *have happened*, *might happen*, or *will never happen.* All three drive curiosity because people want to know what happens next.

i) Ex: Almost every chapter in this book has a story.

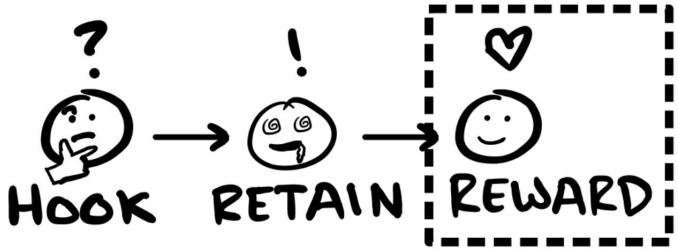
ii) Ex: “My editor made me do 19 drafts of this book - here’s what I did to him.”

iii) Ex: “My journey from sleeping on the bottom floor of a gym to the top floor of a 5-star hotel.”

You can use lists, steps, and stories on their own or interweave them. For example, you can have lists within steps, and a story about each list item. You can have stories to reinforce the value of a step. You can have a list of stories or many ongoing storylines. Etc. Your creativity is the only limit here. That’s why people who make a lot of content call themselves content *creators*. This chapter, for example, has lists within steps and stories interweaving them.

Action Step: Use lists, steps, and stories to keep your audience curious. Embed questions in their minds to make them want to know what happens *next*.

3) Reward



Anyone can think of cool hooks and organize their content using lists, steps, or stories. But the real question is - is it good? Does it satisfy the reason they watched to begin with? Does it make people want to share it? How good your content is depends on how often it rewards your audience in the time it takes them to consume it. Think *value per second*. For example, the same person who gets bored three seconds into a ten-second video may also binge a 900-page book. And that same person may binge a television series for eight hours straight. So there is no such thing as too long, only *too boring*.

Now, we can't guarantee a specific reward. But, we can increase the chance reward happens by:

- Hooking the *right* audience with proper topics, headlines, and formatting
- Retaining them with lists, steps, and stories to get them curious and wanting more
- Clearly satisfying the reason the content hooked them to begin with.

Example: If your hook promises "7 Ways to Make Up with Your Spouse" and you give:

(A) four ways (B) seven ways that stunk (or they've heard them all before). (C) you're talking to a room of single guys who don't have spouses, *you did a bad job of rewarding.* People will not want to watch again, and certainly won't share it.

Example: If your hook promises "4 Marketing Strategies Dentists Can Use" and they can't use them, they will not share it or watch your content in the future. *You did a bad job of rewarding.*

<u>Bottom line:</u> I've had tons of content I thought would smash records but the audience smashed the next button instead. So no matter how good you think your content is, the audience decides. Rewarding your audience means *matching or exceeding their expectations when they decide to consume your content*. Here's how you know if you succeeded: *your audience grows*. If it's not growing, your stuff isn't that good. Practice and you'll get better.

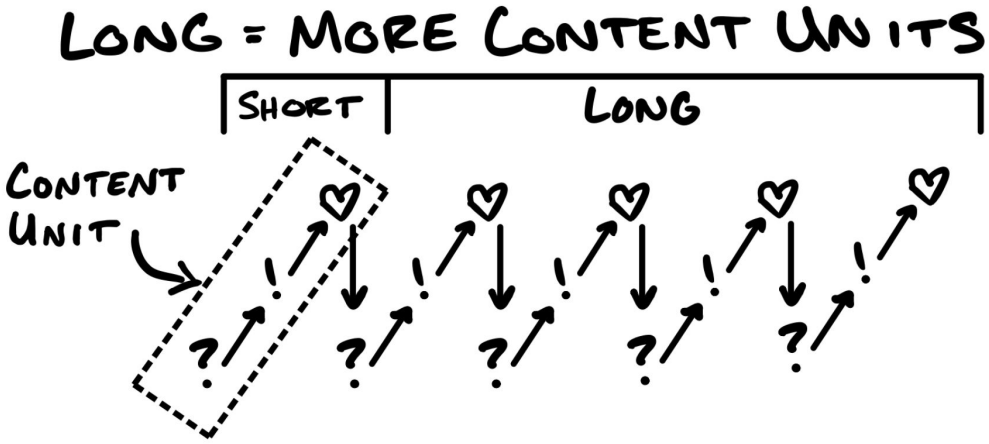
Action Step: Provide more value than anyone else. Make good on your promises. Clearly satisfy the hook you used to get their

attention. In other words, completely answer the unresolved questions you embedded in their minds.

So what's the difference between short and long form content? Answer: not much.

If you recall from earlier, the smallest amount of material it takes to hook, retain and reward attention is a **content unit**. So to create a longer piece of content, we simply link content units together.

For example, a single step in a five-step list might be a content unit. When we link all five together, we have a longer piece of content. Here's a visual to drive it home.



Shorter content hooks, retains, rewards fewer times. Longer content does it more times. And doing it more times takes more skill because you have to string more "good" content units in a row. For example, a new comedian typically will only get a few minutes on stage to perform their "bit." Only a master comic gets an hour. It takes practice to reward attention just often enough to keep it for that long. So, start small, then build from there. Even if you start with longer content, which is fine, I suggest starting with shorter versions. You'll

have an easier go of it. Many successful authors with epic-length novels started by writing…you guessed it…short stories.

Pro Tip: Make All Your Content For Strangers:

This is important. Pay attention. If you want to *grow* your warm audience, then you need to make content assuming the people consuming it have never heard of you before. If you make it for strangers then strangers will like it because… *you made it for them*. And they'll share it. And your audience will grow that much faster. And consider the alternative, you litter your content with "inside jokes" that no one gets besides your audience. Cool for you guys, but no one else will feel welcome. And your audience growth will slow down. This is one of the most common mistakes I see content creators make - so don't make it. So make every piece of content assuming the person has never heard of you before. And everyone who already knows you won't mind. They'll appreciate the reminders.

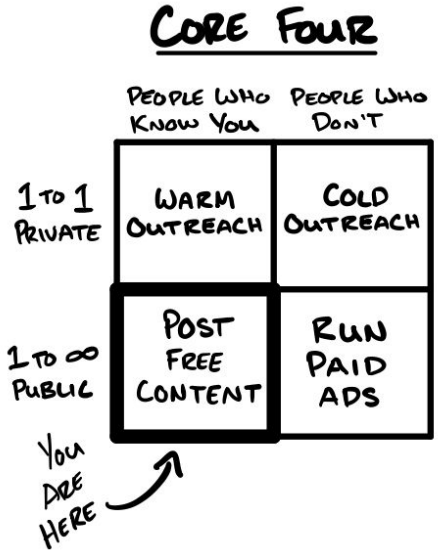
Once you understand how to make a content unit, all you have to do is *more*. Then, your audience will grow. And once your audience grows big enough, you may want to monetize it. I had too much to say to fit into one chapter, so we'll talk about how to monetize the audience in the next one.

See you there.

#2 Post Free Content Part II

Monetize Your Audience

"Give-give-give, give-give-give, until they ask"



The point of this chapter is to show you how to monetize your warm audience. First, we talk about how we can make offers and not be a spam monster - mastering the give : ask ratio. Then we'll talk about the two offer strategies to monetize the audience. After that, I'll talk about how to scale your output so you can grow a bigger audience faster and make even more money. Then, I'll share a bunch of lessons I've learned in building my own audience that I wish I had known sooner. Finally, I'll wrap this up with how you can take action on everything *today*.

Mastering the Give : Ask ratio

Gary Vaynerchuk popularized “jab, jab, jab, right hook.” It simplifies the idea of giving to your audience many times before making an ask. You deposit goodwill with rewarding content, then withdraw from it by making offers. When you deposit goodwill, your audience pays more attention. When you deposit goodwill, your audience is more likely to do what you ask. So I try to “under-ask” my audience and build as much goodwill as possible.

Thankfully, the give : ask ratio has been well-studied. Television averages 13 minutes of advertising per 60 minutes of air time. That means 47 min are dedicated to ‘giving,’ and 13 min are dedicated to ‘asking’. That’s roughly a 3.5:1 ratio of giving to asking. On Facebook, it’s roughly 4 content posts for every 1 ad on the newsfeed. This gives us an idea of the minimum give : ask ratio we can sustain. After all, television and Facebook are mature platforms. They care less about growing their audiences and care more about making money from them. So they give less and ask more. Which means “give, give, give, ask” is the ratio that gets us closer to *maximally monetizing* an audience without shrinking it. But, most of us want to grow, so we shouldn’t model them. We should model growing platforms.

So what do growing platforms do? They display lots of content without many advertisements at all. In short, they give give give… give give give…give give give…give give give…maybe ask. They dramatically over give and under ask. Why? Because the more you reward your audience, the bigger it gets. So if you want to grow an audience, give far far more than you ask.



And now that I have some experience with it, I've got a slight tweak on the traditional give-ask strategy that puts it on steroids: *Give until they ask.*



People are always waiting for you to ask for money. And when you don't, they trust you more. They share your stuff more. You grow faster, etc. But I'm not some altruistic saint. I'm here to make money. After all, I wouldn't be a good businessman if I weren't making any.

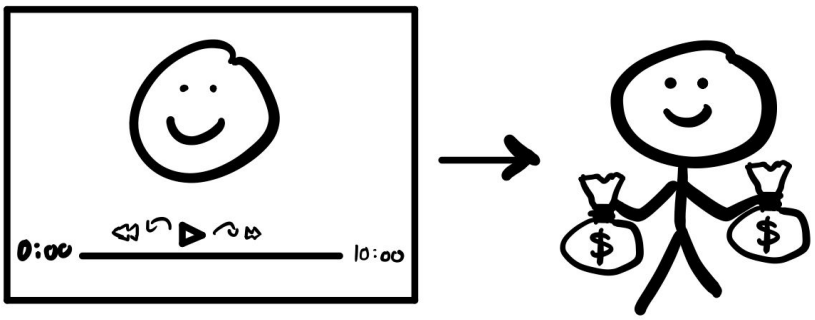
So, it's simple. If you give enough, *people start asking you*. It makes people uncomfortable to continue to receive without giving back. It is core to our culture and DNA. They'll go to your website, DM you, email you, etc., to ask for more. Not only that, when you use this strategy, you get the *best* customers. They are the ones who are the biggest 'givers.' They are the ones who, even as paying customers, still feel they get the better end of the deal. And best of all, if you advertise this way, *your growth never slows*. When you use this strategy, you *give in public, ask in private*. You let the audience self-select when they're ready to give you money. That's why, in my opinion, *give until they ask* is the best strategy. But, if you feel like asking, I get it. So, let's talk about how to ask. If you're gonna do it, you might as well do it well.

Bottom Line: The moment you start asking for money is the moment you decide to slow down your growth. So the more patient you are, the more you will get when you finally make your ask.

Action Step: Give give give give give give *until they ask*

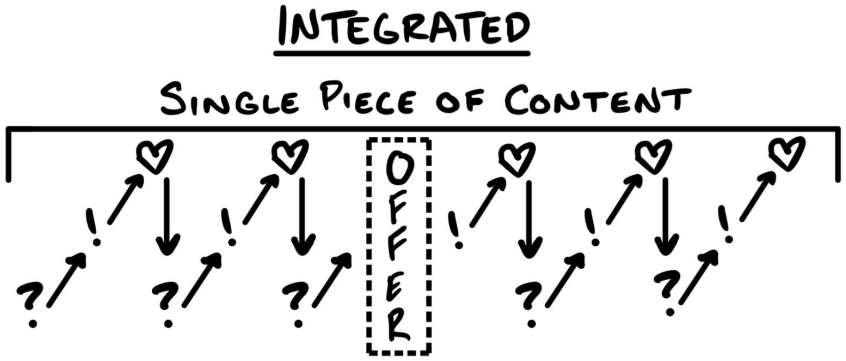
> **Pro Tip: Give in public, ask in private.**
>
> If you continue to give in public, people will ask you privately to sell them stuff. Bank on it. The best of both worlds is to never stop giving in public and get an increasing number of people asking you privately to buy your stuff. Give give give, and you will get - without losing goodwill or slowing your audience growth.

How To Make Money From Content: Ask



To be clear, I think you should use the *give until they ask* strategy. But, if you need to pay rent, feed your family, etc., I get it. Sometimes you gotta ask. So let's talk about how to do that without sounding like a nincompoop.

Think of ‘asks’ as commercials. You *interrupt this program with a very important message*. Since you are the one providing the value, you interrupt your own content with commercials about the stuff you sell. But, since it’s your audience, you pay the cost of potential loss of trust, slowing growth, and of course, the time it took you to gather the audience in the first place. But money-wise, it’s free. Now, I use two strategies to weave promotions into content: integrated offers and intermittent offers. Let’s cover both.



Integrated: You can advertise in every piece of content so long as you keep your give : ask ratio high. You will continue to grow your warm audience *and* get engaged leads. Win-win.

For example, if I make an hour-long podcast, having 3 x 30-second ads means I’d have 58.5 min of giving to 1.5 min of asking. Well above the 3:1 ratio.

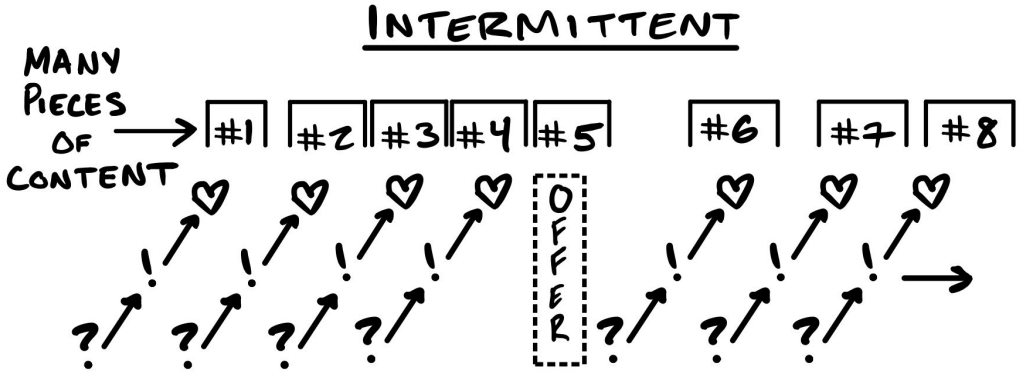
On the flip side, I had a friend who had a podcast that blew up quickly. Eager to monetize his new audience, he started making offers (asking) too frequently -*in*- the content. His podcast not only stopped growing, it actually shrank! Don’t be like that. Don’t kill your golden goose. It’s a balancing act. Over-give to protect your most valuable asset - the goodwill of your audience.

Action step: I most commonly integrate the ‘asks’ - aka - CTAs after a valuable moment or the end of the content piece. Consider trying one of those places first - and make sure your audience growth doesn’t slow. Then add in the second and so forth.

Pro Tip: PS Statement Asks

The “PS” statement is one of the most read parts of any content. Often, because it summarizes the main thing the author wants the audience to do. So, I try to include them in everything I write. It’s also one of my favorite places to put make asks.

PS - see, everyone reads these.



Intermittent: The second way you can monetize is through intermittent asks. Here’s how it works. You make many pieces of content of pure ‘gives’ then occasionally make an ‘ask’ piece. Example: You make 10 ‘give’ posts, and on the 11th, you promote your stuff.

The difference between the first way and the second way depends on the platform. On short platforms, the intermittent way will dominate. On long-form platforms, integrations are often your best bet.

When you make your ask, you either advertise *your core offer,* or *you advertise your lead magnet*. That's it. Don't overcomplicate this.

Lead Magnet Example: If I just talked about a way to get more leads on a post/video/podcast/etc., I would then say, "I have 11 more tips that have helped me do this. Go to my site to grab a pretty visual of them." And as long as I have an audience that wants to get more leads, this will get some of them to engage. Then, the thank you page after the opt-in page for my lead magnet would display my paid offer with some video explaining how it works. Bonus points if your lead magnet is relevant to your content advertising it.

Offer Example: You can also 'go for the jugular' with your core offer and go straight for the sale. The direct path to money. We model our offer from the last chapter.

"I'm looking for 5 (specific avatar) to help achieve (dream outcome) in (time delay). The best part is, you don't have to (effort and sacrifice). And if you don't get (dream outcome), I will do two things (increase perceived likelihood of achievement): 1) I will hand you your money back 2) I will work with you until you do. I do this because I want everyone to have an amazing experience with us and because I'm confident I can deliver on my promise. If that sounds fair, DM me/book a call/comment below/reply to this email/ etc."

After you make your ask, get back to providing value.

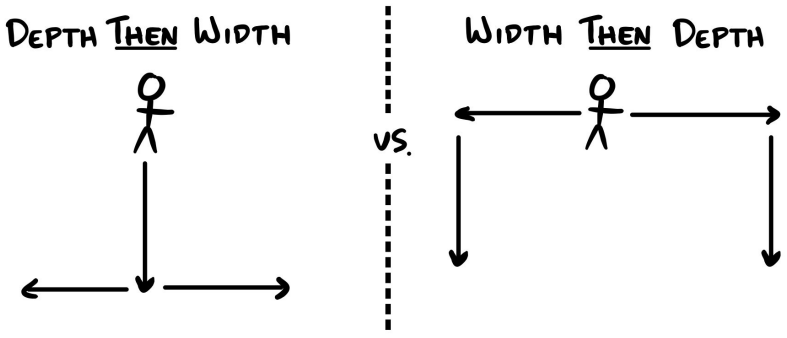
Pro Tip: $100M Offers

My first book, $100M Offers, breaks down the offer creation process step by step. If you want to know how to create a valuable offer that the *right* person would feel stupid saying no to…go check out that book (the kindle version is sold as cheap as the platform will allow me to sell it, if you're strapped for cash). If it helps you feel more comfortable, more than 10,000 people left it a 5-star review in the first fifteen months since it was published. And it has sat atop the #1 best seller in marketing, advertising, sales lists for 100+ weeks and counting. If you don't know what to sell, read that book to get it right the first time.

*^This box is an example of an integration.

Action Step One: Pick whether you integrate it or make an intermittent ask. Then, pick whether you'll advertise your core offer or lead magnet. If you're not sure, do the lead magnet. It's lower risk.

How to Scale It



After you start asking, you’re gonna start getting leads and making money. But you don't want to stop there, do you? Didn’t think so. Cool, so let’s talk about scale.

There are two opposing strategies to scale your warm audience. They both follow progressive steps. First, you have the depth-then-width approach. Then, you have the width-then-depth approach. Both are right. Here’s how they work:

Depth then width: Maximize a platform, then move onto the next platform.

Step #1: Post content on a relevant platform.

Step #2: Post content regularly on that platform.

Step #3: Maximize quality and quantity of the content on that platform. Short form, you may sometimes be able to get up to ten times per day per platform. Long form, you may have to get up to five days per week (see soap operas).

Step #4: Add another platform while maintaining the quality and quantity on the first platform.

Step #5: Repeat steps 1-4 until all relevant platforms are maximized.

Advantages: Once you figure out one platform, you maximize your return on that effort. Audiences compound faster the more you do. You take advantage of this compounding. Fewer resources are required to make this work.

Disadvantages: You have less low hanging fruit of new platforms and new audiences. You don't accomplish the feeling of 'omnipresence.' In the beginning, you risk your business being reliant on a single channel. This is a risk because platforms change all the time and sometimes ban you for no reason. If you only have one way to get customers, it can kill your business if it gets shut down.

Width then depth: Get on every platform early, then maximize them together.

Step #1: Post content on a relevant platform.

Step #2: Post content regularly on that platform.

Step #3: *Here's where this strategy differs from the one before.* Instead of maximizing your first platform. Move onto the next relevant platform while maintaining the previous.

Step #4: Continue until you are on all relevant platforms.

Step #5: Now, maximize your content creation on all platforms at once.

Advantages: You reach a broader audience faster. And, you can "repurpose" your content. So with a little extra work, you can capture tons of efficiency. With minimal changes to the format, you can make the same content fit multiple platforms. For example, it takes little extra effort to format a single short video across all platforms distributing short video content.

Disadvantages: It costs more labor, attention, and time, to do this well. Oftentimes, people end up with lots of bad content everywhere. Sucky fluff. No bueno.

If you already have a sizable business, scale up faster and reap the rewards of an asset that only gets better with time. I said it before and I'll say it again. The best day to start posting content was the day you were born. The second best day is today. Don't wait like I did.

Pro Tip: How I Get It Done

I am not a full time content creator. I run businesses. But, content creation is a part of my responsibility. Here's my simple process for recording.

1) I find topics using the five ways from the "topics" section in Part I of this chapter. This takes me about an hour.

2) I sit down twice every month and record thirty or so short clips based on Step 1.

3) On the same day, I record 2-4 longer videos unpacking tweets that had more stories or relevant examples. This creates my longer form content.

If this sounds simplistic, it's because it is. Just start. You can add volume over time.

Action Step: Pick an approach. Start posting. Then, go up the scaling steps over time.

> **Pro Tip: Only One Call-To-Action At A Time**
>
> '*A confused mind doesn't buy*' is a common saying in the sales and marketing world. To increase how many people do what you want, only ask them to do one thing per call to action. For example, don't ask people to "share, like subscribe, and comment" at the same time. Because instead of doing them all, they'll do none. Instead, if you want them to share, *only* ask them to share. And if you want them to buy, *only* ask them to buy. Make up your mind, so they don't have to.

Why You Should Make Content (even if it's not your primary advertising strategy)

January 2020.

I called all the major departments to a meeting to answer an important question: *Why isn't our paid advertising working like it used to?* Opinions flooded the room. "The creative…the copy…the offer…our pages…our sales process…our price…" They shot back and forth at each other, every bit as invested as I was in solving the problem.

Leila and I sat quietly as the team debated. After the din died down, Leila, in her wise fashion, asked a different question: *What did we <u>stop</u> doing in the months before the decline*?

A new debate arose and a unanimous answer surfaced: Alex stopped making gym content and started talking about general business. Now, I didn't know how important that was, but I had to find out. So, I sent a survey to our gym owners. I asked if they had consumed any content of mine *before* they booked a call. The results astounded me.

78% of all clients had consumed at least TWO long form pieces of content, prior to booking a call.

I had fallen into my old ways and given paid ads all the credit. But, our free content was nurturing the demand. Don't make the same mistake I did. Your free content gives strangers an opportunity to find, get value from, and share your stuff. And, it warms people on the fence that go to and come from the cold audience methods we dive into next. So even if it's hard to measure, free content gets you better returns on all advertising methods.

Bottom line: Start making content relevant to your audience. It will make you more money.

7 Lessons I've Learned From Making Content

1) **Switch from "How to" to "How I." From "This is the best way" to "These are my favorite ways" etc.** (especially when starting out). Talk about what you've done, not what others should do. What you like, not this is *the* best. When you talk about experience, no one can question you. This makes you bulletproof.

    a) I make my oatmeal this way vs. you should make your oatmeal this way.

b) How I Built My 7-Figure Agency vs. How To Build a 7-Figure Agency.

c) My favorite way to generate leads for my business vs. This is the best way to generate leads for your business.

It’s subtle. But when you tell your experience, you are sharing value. When you tell a stranger what to do, it's hard to avoid coming off preachy or arrogant. This helps avoid it.

2) **We Need To Be Reminded More Than We Need To Be Taught:** You’re a silly goose if you think 100 percent of your audience listens 100 percent of the time. For example, I post about my book every single day. I surveyed my audience and asked them if they knew I had a book. One in five that saw the post said they didn’t know. Keep repeating yourself. You’ll get bored of your content before your whole audience even sees it.

3) **Puddles, Ponds, Lakes, Oceans.** Narrow the focus of your content. If you have a small local business, you probably shouldn’t make general business content. Not at first, at least. Why? The audience will listen to people with better track records than you. But you can narrow your topics to what you do and the place you do it. Example: plumbing in a certain town. If you do that, you can become king of that puddle. Over time, you can expand your plumbing puddle to the general local business pond. Then the lake of brick & mortar chains and so forth. Then eventually, the ocean of general business.

4) **Content Creates Tools For Salespeople**. Some content will perform well and get more people interested in buying your stuff. That content *helps your sales team*. Create a master list of your “greatest hits.” Label each ‘hit’ with the problem it solves and the benefit it provides. Then, your sales team can send it before or after sales calls and help people decide to buy. They work especially well if the content resolves specific concerns prospects commonly

face.

5) **Free Content Retains Paying Customers**. How a customer gets value from you matters less than where they got it. Imagine a person pays for your thing and then consumes your free content. If your free content is valuable, they will like you more and stay loyal to your business longer. On the flip side, if they consume your free content, and it sucks, they will like your paid product less. Here's something you may not know. Somebody who buys your stuff is *more likely* to consume your free content. This is why it's so important to make your free content good - your customers will include it in how they calculate their ROI from your paid thing.

6) **People don't have shorter attention spans, they have higher standards.** Repeated for emphasis: *there's no such thing as too long, only too boring.* Streaming platforms have proven that people will spend hours binging long form content *if they like it*. Our biology hasn't changed, our circumstances have. They have more rewarding stuff to choose from. So make good stuff people like and reap the rewards rather than whining about people's "short attention spans."

7) **Avoid Pre-Scheduling Posts**. The posts I manually post perform better than ones I pre-schedule. Here's my theory. When you manually post, you know that within seconds you will be rewarded or punished for the quality of the content. Because of that close feedback loop, you try *that much harder* to make it better. When I schedule stuff out, I don't feel that same pressure. So whenever I post, or my team does, we strongly believe in someone pressing the 'submit' button because it gives that last bit of pressure to get it right. Try it.

Benchmarks - How Well Am I Doing?

If our audience grows, we did good. But if our audience grows fast, we did *gooder*. So I like to measure my audience size and speed of growth monthly.

Here's what I measure:

1) Total followers and reach - *How big*

    a) Follower Example: If I go from 1000 followers across all platforms to 1500, I grew my audience by 500.

    b) Reach Example: If I go from 10,000 people seeing my stuff to 15,000 people seeing my stuff, I grew my *reach* by 5,000 people.

2) Rate of getting followers and reach - *How fast*

    You compare the growth between months:

    a) Example: If I gained those 500 followers in a month, that would make it a 50% growth month. (500 New / 1000 Started = 50% growth rate).

    b) Example: If I reached those 5000 extra people in a month, that would make it a 50% growth month. (5000 New / 10,000 Started = 50% growth rate)

Remember, we can only control inputs. Measuring outputs is only useful if we are consistent with inputs. So, pick the posting cadence you want to stick with on a particular platform. Then pick your 'ask' cadence on that platform (how you will direct people to become engaged leads). Then, start, and…Do. Not. Stop.



For reference, I posted a new podcast twice a week for four years before even getting picked up on the Top 100 list. Because I did the same thing every week for years, I knew I could trust the feedback. In the beginning, it didn't grow much. It took time for me to get better. And I knew I had to make more, over a long time, for that to happen.

So if your listeners go from ten to fifteen in a month, that’s progress baby! Even with small absolute numbers, that’s fifty percent monthly growth! It’s why I like to measure both the absolute and relative growth and pick the one that makes me feel better (ha!). As my friend Dr. Kashey says, “The more ways you measure, the more ways you can win.” Be consistent. Measure a lot. Adapt to feedback. Be a winner.

To close the loop, in its fifth year, my podcast- *The* Game, became a Top 10 podcast in the US for business and top 500 in the world. This was only possible *after 5 years* of *multiple podcasts per week every week*. Remember, everyone starts at zero. You just gotta give time, time.

Your First Post

You've probably been providing value to other humans knowingly or unknowingly for a while. So the first post you make, *you can make an ask.* My hope is that it gets you your first engaged lead. If it doesn't, you need to give for a while, then make an ask once you've earned the right to. To show you that I'm not making this up, below you can find my first business post ever. Is it ideal? No. I had no idea what I was doing. Should you copy it, probably not. Main point: don't be afraid of what other people think. If someone won't speak at your funeral, you shouldn't care about their opinion while you're alive. Honor the few who believe in you by having courage.



Alex Hormozi
April 9, 2013 · Baltimore, MD ·

Everyone,

For those of you who know me, you know two things:

1) I am terrible with all things technological. For example, I just heard about spotify a few weeks ago, seriously.
2) I love training/nutrition and "fitness" more than, well, a whole lot.

So, today is sort of special because it marks a day when my love of training vanquished my fear of technology.

What do I mean?

For the better part of a year I have been taking part in a free personal training project with the idea that I would give away free personal training to anyone who was willing to give some of their $500-$1000 to a cause of their choice. This way, they wouldn't have to be motivated by the same thing as me, but be motivated to give to their cause and benefit themselves. When I first introduced the idea, I was happily surprised with the amount of positive support I received.

So, almost a year from my first client, I NOW HAVE A WEBSITE!! to formally show some of the transformations that have gone underway using my programming and as a formal means of contacting me about signing up.
I CURRENTLY HAVE A FEW SLOTS OPEN IN MY ROSTER, SO DROP ME A NOTE QUICKLY IF YOU ARE INTERESTED! THANKS SO MUCH!

Take a second to check out some of the ridiculous transformations in record. time. CHECK IT OUT

Whenever I read this, I just think "you goon." But hey, I was trying. And for that, I'm proud.

Recap

We covered eight things:

1) The Content Unit - done
2) Short vs. Long Form Content – done
3) Mastering the Give:Ask Ratio – done
4) How to Ask – done
5) How to Scale It – done
6) Lessons From Content – done
7) Benchmarks – done
8) Your First Post – done

Now, you know. Nothing's stopping you.

So What Do I Do Right Now?

Posting free content is less predictable than, but complementary to, warm reach outs. So *keep doing warm reach outs.* Also, posting free content grows your warm audience. And a bigger warm audience means more people for warm reach outs. So free content gets engaged leads on its own and *keeps getting* engaged leads through warm reach outs. Instead of ditching one for the other, I recommend you post free content *in addition to* warm reach outs.

Let's fill out our daily action commitment for our first platform.

Post Content Daily Checklist	
Who:	Yourself
What:	Value: Give give give until they ask
Where:	Any media platform
To Whom:	People who already follow you
When:	Every morning, 7 days a week
Why:	Build goodwill. Get engaged leads.
How:	Written, image, videos, audio posts
How Much:	100 min per day
How Many:	As many times as the platform shows it
How Long:	As long as it takes.

Next Up

First, we start with warm outreach. We reach out to every person we have permission to contact. Second, we post publicly about the successes and lessons we have from our first clients. We post testimonials. We provide value. Then occasionally ask. We commit to doing both of these activities every day.

With these two methods alone can eventually build a six- or seven-figure business. But you may want to go faster. So we venture from warm audiences who know us, to cold audiences who don't. We begin *reaching out to strangers*. This begins the third step in our advertising journey: cold outreach.

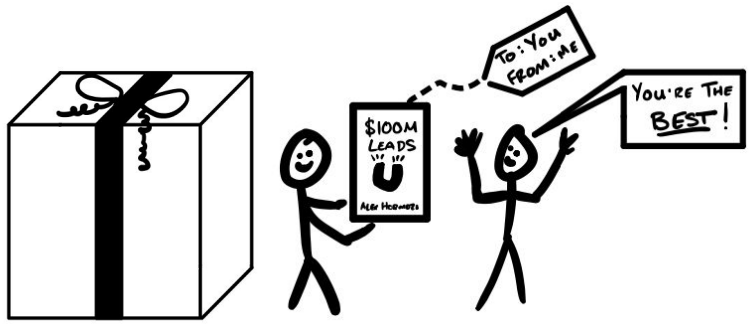
FREE GIFT: Everything I've Learned From Posting Content

I had to cut a lot of material to make this book manageable. If you want to know the fast and easy way to make content that builds trust in an audience - go to **Acquisition.com/training/leads**. And, if you needed another reason besides 'it'll make you money'....it won't cost you any. It's free. Enjoy. And as always, you can also scan the QR code below if you hate typing.



Free Goodwill

"He who said money can't buy happiness hasn't given enough away." – Unknown



People who give without expectation live longer, happier lives *and* make more money. So if we've got a shot at that during our time together, darn it, I'm gonna try.

To do that, I have a question for you…

Would you help someone you've never met if it cost you nothing, but you didn't get credit?

Who is this person you ask? They are like you. Or, at least, like you used to be. Less experienced, wanting to make a difference, and needing help, but not sure where to look.

Acquisition.com's mission is *to make business accessible to everyone*. Everything we do stems from that mission. And, the only way for us to accomplish that mission is by reaching…well… *everyone*.

This is where you come in. Most people do, in fact, judge a book by its cover (and its reviews). So here's my ask on behalf of a struggling entrepreneur you've never met:

Please help that entrepreneur by leaving this book a review.

Your gift costs no money and less than 60 seconds to make real, but can change a fellow entrepreneur's life *forever*. Your review could help…

….one more small businesses provide for their community.

….one more entrepreneur support their family.

….one more employee get meaningful work.

…one more client transform their life.

…one more dream come true.

To get that 'feel good' feeling and help this person for real, all you have to do is….and it takes less than 60 seconds…leave a review.



If you are on audible - hit the three dots in the top right of your device, click rate & review, then leave a few sentences about the book with a star rating.

If you are reading on kindle or an e-reader - scroll to the bottom of the book, then swipe up and it will prompt a review for you.

If for some reason these changed- you can go to Amazon (or wherever you purchased this) and leave a review right on the book's page.

If all fails, scan this QR code



If you feel good about helping a faceless entrepreneur, you are my kind of people. Welcome to #mozination. You're one of us.

I'm that much more excited to help you get more leads than you can possibly imagine. You'll love the tactics I'm about to share in the coming chapters. Thank you from the bottom of my heart. Now, back to our regularly scheduled programming.

- Your biggest fan, Alex

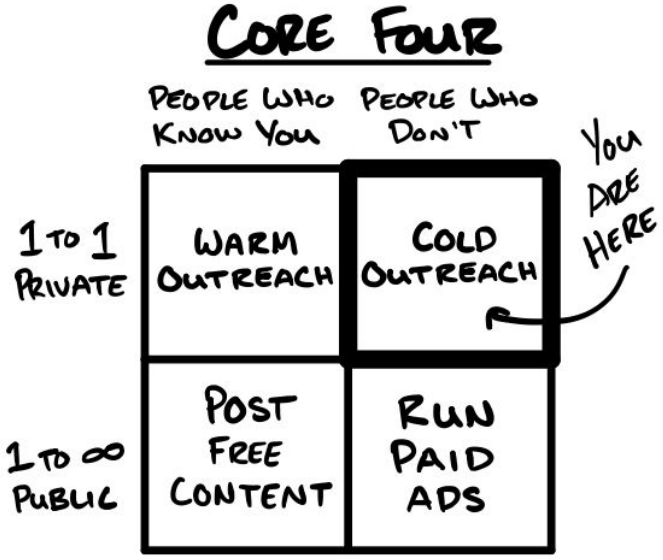


PS - Fun fact: If you provide something of value to another person, it makes you more valuable to them. If you'd like goodwill straight from another entrepreneur - and you believe this book will help them - send this book their way.

#3 Cold Outreach

How To Reach Out To Strangers To Get Engaged Leads

“Quantity has a quality all of its own” - Napoleon Bonaparte



July 2020.

COVID-19 raged. In a matter of months, thirty percent of my customers went out of business. Protestors filled every platform with hate and anger. Politicians made promises. Small businesses suffered in silence. Unemployment skyrocketed. The most tumultuous election ever was upon us. And here we were, trying to generate leads to pay our bills. Employees everywhere, and their families, depended on it.

All three of my companies at the time (Gym Launch, Prestige Labs, and ALAN) relied on brick-and-mortar businesses staying open. And, they were closed. *Brilliant strategy Alex*. To make

matters worse, Apple did a software update that crippled our ads. The market was crap. Our paid ads were crap. And I carried the bucket.

I ran through worst-case scenarios. *How much cash would it take to keep us afloat? How long do I keep paying people when there's no end in sight? Should I dip into personal accounts? Give up a third of my life savings? Half? All of it? What does that say about me?* I had no idea what to do.

Early that Saturday morning…

I tried to sleep long enough for my alarm to wake me, but it was no use. I went to my office and checked Instagram. I had a new message waiting for me:

"Hey Alex - Cale told me you guys don't need salesmen anymore, so my offer got pulled. I quit my job to accept it. Super honored you considered me. I hope you'll consider me again the next time you have openings."

Looking for context, I scrolled up. Reading our earlier messages rewarded me with a pang of guilt. *I was the one who told him to apply.* He took the rejection well. *A sign of a good salesman*. I felt obligated to reply.

"You on?" I messaged.

"Yes," he replied.

"Got 5?"

“Yes”

We hopped on a call. He sounded a little nervous, but I could tell he knew his stuff. *It sucks we don’t have enough leads for this guy…*

“I’ve wanted to work for you a while now. I read your book and used the scripts to become the top producer at my company,” he said.

“That’s awesome. I’m so glad to hear it. What kind of company?” I asked.

“A gym software company.”

I hadn’t heard of them. “Oh interesting. How do you guys get leads?”

“We’re 100% cold outreach.”

“You cold call and cold email gyms, then sell them software?”

“Yea, pretty much.”

“How big is the team?”

“We’ve got about thirty guys.”

A team of 30!? “What’s your revenue like if you can share that with me.”

“We’re doing about $10,000,000 per month now.”

Insane. “Just from cold outreach?”

“Yea, we run some ads, but we haven’t cracked that yet.”

“And you do this with a retention offer? You’re not even really making gyms more money?”

“Yea, it's definitely not as easy to sell as the stuff you do for gyms.”

“Do you think you could use the same cold outreach system here?”

“I’ve never started a team, but I bet I could figure it out.”

“Alright. What was the offer Cale pulled?”

“I was gonna be a closer, but he said you guys didn't need one anymore.”

I thought for a moment. “Well, given our current lead volume, he’s probably right. But, *if you can get your own leads*, I’ll give you the runway to get cold outreach going. What do you think?”

“It takes a while to get going. I’ll have to figure out the scripts for your offer.”

“Yeah, that makes sense. How long, you think?”

“I’m confident I could make it profitable in twelve weeks.”

“Alright, deal. I’ll let Cale know the plan. To be clear, you’ll be expected to figure all this out. The software. The lists. Everything. I’ll front you the time, but we can’t support you much beyond that.”

“Understood.”

Here’s what happened during the months that followed:

September: 0 Sales. Zippola. Nothin’. Zilch. Nada.

October: 2 Sales ($32,000 in revenue) Team asks me to pull the plug on cold outreach.

December: 4 Sales ($64,000 in revenue) Team asks me to pull the plug, again.

January: 6 Sales ($96,000 in revenue)

February: 10 Sales ($160,000 in revenue)

March: 14 Sales ($224,000 in revenue)

April: 20 Sales ($320,000 in revenue)

May: 30 Sales ($480,000 in revenue)

Today: Cold outreach generates millions per month for our businesses

Making this work took every (legal) cold outreach method we knew. Cold calls….Cold emails….Cold Direct Messages….Voicemails. Everything. But, piece by piece, we built a reliable customer-getting machine. I wanted something that would *endure*.

And that's what I'm gonna show you how to build.

I learned five important lessons from this experience:

1) There was another company in my space making *a lot* more money than mine. It broke my belief about how big the market really was.

2) They made all their money through *private* advertising. I had no way of knowing they existed unless they contacted me first. So, they kind of operated in secret.

3) They built a very profitable cold outreach machine in *my* space. If they could do it, so could I.

4) It's good to have proper expectations. Cold outreach veterans told me it would take a year to scale. I figured we could do it in twelve weeks. I was wrong. It took almost a year. Cold outreach

takes a long time. At least, it did for me.

5) We tried cold outreach two times before and failed. Working with a person that had done it all before was immensely helpful in getting this going. I hope to be that person for you now.

How Cold Outreach Works



At some point, you'll want one of two things. Either, you'll want to grow faster than you currently are. Or, you'll want to increase the predictability of your lead flow…

Here's how we can do that. We advertise to people who don't know us. Cold audiences. And like before, we can contact them publicly or privately. In this chapter, we focus on private one-to-one communication with cold outreach. For added context, cold outreach sits atop the foundation of warm outreach. So think of this as the more advanced cousin of warm outreach, no longer limited by your warm audience.

If you can figure out a way to contact somebody one-to-one, you can use it for cold outreach. You knock on 100 doors. You make 100 phone calls. You send 100 direct messages. You send 100 voicemails. All these are examples of cold outreach that have made

companies zillions. It worked 100 years ago. It works today. And when the platforms change, it'll work tomorrow.

Cold outreach has one key difference from warm outreach: trust. Strangers don't trust you.

And compared to people who know us, strangers present three new problems.

1) First, you don't have a way to contact them. Duh.

2) Second, even if you can contact them, they ignore you.

3) Third, even if they give you their attention, they're not interested.

Let me describe what these problems look like in the real world.

If you're knocking on doors, you don't have the addresses. Then, even if you do, they don't open the door when you knock. If they open, they still tell you to pound sand.

If you're making cold calls, you don't have their phone numbers. Even if you do, they don't pick up. If they pick up, they hang up on you.

If you're sending cold emails, you don't have their email addresses. Even if you do, they don't open the email. Even if they do, they don't respond.

If you're sending direct messages, you don't have a place to send it. Even if you do, they don't read it. Even if they read it, they don't reply.

If you're sending voice memos or text messages, you don't have their numbers. Even if you do, they don't read or listen to it. Even if they read or listen to it, they don't reply.

Now that we got that out of the way, the order we solve these problems is:

1) Get a way to contact them

2) Figure out what to say

3) Contact them until they're ready and able to listen

The Result. We find lots of ways to contact the most qualified strangers. We reach out to a lot of them in a lot of ways a lot of times. Then, we overwhelm them with value upfront to get them to show enough interest to move forward.

Author Note: It'll Take A Few More Steps Than Normal

As a personal rule of thumb, I sell expensive stuff. I sell expensive stuff better when I do it in multiple steps (rather than on the first contact). So my first priority is to get the prospect to show interest in the stuff I sell. When they show interest, I schedule a time to sell them. If my lead magnet requires a second exchange to deliver it, I do that then. If my lead magnet provides value on its own, then the next call is to talk about the value they received. Either way works.

Cold outreach is a numbers game. The more people you reach out to the more engaged leads you get. Once we figure out how much outreach it takes to engage a lead, then we only have one thing to do…*more*. Let's go hunting!

As there are three new problems strangers introduce, I've divided this chapter into three steps. One step per problem. First, we get a targeted list of leads. Next, we need to know what to say to get them to reply. Third, we make up for a lower response rate by increasing the volume and type of our reach out attempts.

Problem #1: "But how do I contact them?" → **Build a List**



Up until this point, from warm reach outs and posting free content, you've had to accept the leads that came to you from your warm audience. No more. With cold outreach, unlike any other way of advertising, we get to be as specific as we want. Only want to talk to hedge fund managers managing over $1B? Done. You can do that. Only want to speak with golf apparel retail store owners over $3M in sales? Done. Only want to talk to influencers who get over 50,000 unique page views per month? Done. Now *we* get to pick our targets rather than them picking us.

Now, you probably don't have a way to reach out to 1000 perfect fit strangers. And if we're gonna get them to buy from us, we've gotta first find a way to contact them–*duh*. So let's solve that problem first.

There are three different ways I get my targeted lead lists. First, I use software to scrape a list of names. Second, I pay brokers to assemble me a list of targeted leads. And if neither of those work, I manually scrape a list of names myself. Here's the process.

- Step #1 Softwares: I subscribe to as many softwares as I can that scrape leads from different sources. I search them all based on my criteria. The software then spits out names, job titles, contact information, etc. I try out a representative sample, say a few hundred from each software I use. Then, if the contact information is up to date, the leads are responsive, and they are the type of person the software claims them to be, bingo! Then I

get as many leads as the software will give me. But if I can't seem to find the right audience, I move onto step two.

- Step #2 Brokers: I go to multiple list brokers and ask them to make me a list based on my audience criteria. They then send me a sample. I test out sample lists from each of the brokers. If I get good results from one or more brokers, I stick with their lists. And if I still can't find who I'm looking for, I move to step three.

- Step #3 Elbow Grease: I join groups and communities that I think have my audience. When I find people that meet my qualifications, I check to see if they have ways to contact them in the group's directory–like links to their social media profiles, etc. If they do, I add them to my list. If they don't, I can reach out to them within the platform hosting the group. I prefer to find contact information outside the group so I don't come off as someone solely trying to milk the group for business *but I will if I have to*.

So I work my way from the most accessible leads to the least accessible leads. Here's an important point. If you can search the database, so can everyone else. But if you assemble a list of names yourself, it's less likely that person has already received many cold reach outs from other companies. So they're the freshest. Downside: it takes the most time. Of course, you can pay someone else to do this for you once you figure it out for yourself, but we're only talking about getting started in this chapter. We'll talk about scaling in Section IV.

Action Step: Find your scraping tool by searching "outbound leads scraping tool" or "database lead scraping." Find brokers the same way. With a few clicks, you'll find what you're looking for. Put your first 1000 names together. If you have more time than

money, you might want to start at step three since it only costs time.

> **Pro Tip: Interest Groups Are The Warmest Cold Audience You Can Get**
>
> Interest groups contain the highest quality leads because they are concentrated pools of people looking for a solution. Give them one. Nowadays, there's software that can scrape information from these groups. Use it. They're one of my favorite places to fish.

Problem #2: "I have my list, but what do I say to them?"
→Personalize, Then Give Big Fast Value

Now that you have your list of leads, you gotta figure out what to say. I went over a lot of scripting in the Warm Reach Outs section– this section builds on that one. At the end of this chapter, I also include three sample scripts you can model for cold calls, cold emails, and cold chat messaging. That being said, there are two important factors I emphasize to get strangers to engage: *personalization* and *big fast value*. This is important because they don't know us and they don't trust us. We've gotta overcome both issues in a matter of seconds.

a) They Don't Know Us→Personalize (Act Like You Know Them).
To get more leads to engage, we want the message to *look* like it's from someone they know. The best way to do that is to actually know something about the person you are contacting. In essence, we want our *cold* reach out to look like a *warm* reach out.

…Imagine your phone rings from an unknown number and area code. Are you likely to pick it up? Probably not. What about if the number

is from your area code? A little more likely. Why is that? Because *it might be someone you know*. So to take this concept further, imagine you pick up the phone...

…The person says "<Your name?>" then pausing (like a normal person). You'd say, "yea…who's this?" Now, if that person then went on to say, "it's Alex…*then pauses*…I watched a few of your videos and read that recent blog post you wrote on dog training. It was killer! Really helped me out with my doberman. She's a beast! That peanut butter trick really helped. Thanks for that."

You'd still be wondering what's going on. But you know what you wouldn't be doing?…*hanging up*. Then you hear, "Oh yea, sorry, I got ahead of myself. I work for a company that helps dog trainers fill up their books. We like to partner with the best in the area. So I'm always on the lookout. We worked with someone about an hour north from you…John's Doggy Daycare…heard of them?"

You'd respond yes or no (it doesn't matter), and they'd say, "Yea, we ended up getting them 100 appointments in 30 days using a combination of text email and some ads. Do you offer similar services to them?" To which you'd probably say yes. Then they'd say, "Oh that's perfect. Then we'd be able to use that same campaign in your market and drive leads over to you. If you got a boatload of high paying new dog training customers you wouldn't be upset with me would you?" You'd laugh lightly. "Okay great. Well…tell ya what…I can walk you through the entire thing soup to nuts later today. Will you be around at 4?" And you'd say - sure - or whatever. The point is, if that person had started the call with "hey man, wanna buy some marketing services?" you'd probably have hung up.

Personalization is what gets your foot in the door to get the sale. Basically one to three pieces of information we can find that a friend might know about the prospect. Then we want to complement them on

it, and ideally, show them how it benefited us. People like people who like them. Even if someone doesn't know you, they'll give you more time if you know something about them.

This comes in handy for personal subject lines on emails, the first few messages in chat, or the first few sentences someone hears. Even if someone doesn't know you, they will appreciate the time you took to research them before contacting them. This tiny effort goes a long way.

Action step: Do a little research on each lead before you send them a message. We can do this ourselves, pay people to do it for us, or use software. Batch this work. Then, use your notes to figure out the first thing you'll open with to *feel more familiar.*

Pro Tip: 50% Email Response Rate Bump

I took our cold outreach template and re-wrote it below a third grade reading level. The results: *50% more leads responded*. I recommend running all scripts and messages through a free reading level app online. I won't recommend one because they go out of business all the time, but I promise you can find one. Make your messages easier to understand and more people will respond.

b) They Don't Trust Us → Big Fast Value. The key difference between people who know you and strangers is…strangers give you far less time to prove your worth. And, they need a lot more incentive to move towards you. So make your life easier by "giving away the farm." We're not trying to tickle their interest, we're trying to blow their minds in under thirty seconds.

Like warm reach outs, you can directly make your offer, or offer a lead magnet, or both. It gives the person a strong reason to respond.

I specifically call out ‘big fast value’ rather than “your lead magnet” as a reminder that it needs to be BIG FAST VALUE. If it’s not, or it’s mediocre, you’ll blend in with the ocean of people trying to get their attention. And they’ll treat you the same–they’ll ignore you. Here’s how much it matters:

The first four months of cold outreach felt like torture. We offered a game planning session as our lead magnet. Some gyms took us up on it, but most didn’t. We needed something better. I tested many parts of our process but swapping the lead magnet blew everything else out of the water. We swapped from “game planning” - code for “sales call” - to actually giving them as much free service as we could possibly afford. Our take rates 3x’d and cold outreach became a monster channel for us.

If your offer/lead magnet isn’t working for you, up the ante. Keep offering more until you *make it so good they feel stupid saying no*. They either buy from you or have nice things to say about you. Win-win.

If you forget everything about this chapter, remember one thing: *the goal is to demonstrate big value as fast as possible.* Give yourself a downhill battle by giving away something crazy. Give away something for free people would normally pay for and they will want it. Note: I didn’t say, “so good they should pay for it,” I said, “stuff they actually pay for.” Big difference. Take this to heart and your results will show it.

Action Step: Provide the biggest fastest value you can afford to with your lead magnet or offer. Then, write your scripts. And don't worry, I got your back there. To give you a headstart, I provide sample phone, email, and direct message scripts at the end of the chapter. Note: Phone and chat scripts are never more than a page or two, and cold emails rarely more than half a page. So don't overthink it. There are no awards for prettiest script. Get your first 100 conversations or 10,000 emails out of the way before tweaking it. Get testing. Then tweak as you learn.

Problem #3: "I'm not getting enough chances to tell people about my amazing stuff, what do I do?" → Volume

Once we have our list of names, personal info, and our big sexy lead magnet, we need to get more strangers to see it. We do this in three ways. First, we automate delivery to the greatest extent possible. Next, we automate distribution to the greatest extent possible. Finally, we follow up more times in more ways.

a) Automated Delivery. To the extent that we can, automating delivery unlocks huge scale as someone doesn't need to literally communicate the message to the prospect. This means you get more engaged leads per unit of time (even if fewer engage by overall percentage). Remember, you have far more people who don't know you than people who do. So you don't have to worry *as much* about 'burning through an audience.' Here's what the difference between manual and automated delivery looks like.



Manual Examples: A live person can say a script to someone over the phone. You can send a personal voice memo to each lead. A person can write a handwritten letter to every person on the list. If it takes a person time to convey the message each time, it's manual.



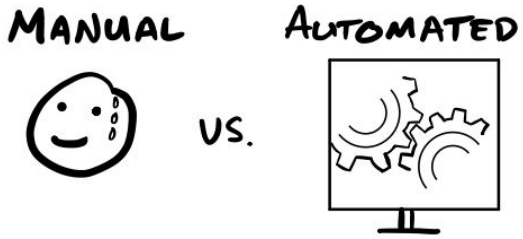
Automated Examples: We can send a pre-recorded voice memo to someone's direct messages. We can send a pre-recorded voicemail to someone's voicemail box. We can send templated emails to an inbox or a templated text to someone's phone. We can send a pre-recorded video. Etc. You record your message one time and then send the same message to everyone.

Pro Tip: Use Technology That Gets You More Engaged Leads For Your Time

Everyday, artificial intelligence, deep fakes and other technology advance. They become more indistinguishable from human communication. This means we will be able to automate elements of what we currently are forced to spend time on. Embrace technology as it comes out to reap the rewards. Ultimately, technology serves a single purpose - to get us more output per unit time. Use it.

b) Automate Distribution. Once we have our messages prepared, we gotta distribute them. And there's no award for who works the hardest, only for who gets the best results. Although one leads to the

other. And as you build your skills, you will find ways to automate portions of the work. I encourage you to automate when ethical and available.



Manual examples: Dial each phone number. Click send on each email, direct message, text, etc.

Automated examples: Use a robot to dial multiple numbers at a time. Send a blast of 1000 emails, texts, voicemails at one time. Etc.

> Generally speaking, you sacrifice personalization for scale. You get a higher response rate with personalized messages. *The fewer leads you have, the less automation you should use.*

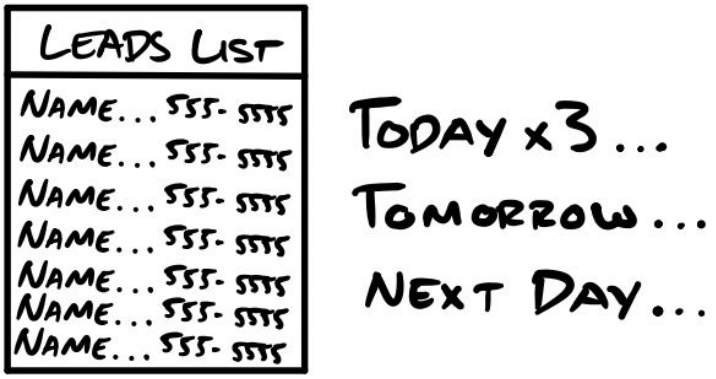
> For example, if there are only 1000 hedge fund managers who meet your criteria, you're gonna wanna personalize every one of them. On the other hand, if you're targeting women 25-45 trying to lose weight, there are tens of millions of them. So you can get away with less personalization. But…if you personalize…you'll get even more (wink).

Pro Tip: Personalization Tech

The perfect combination for maximum leads is max personalization with max volume. And with tech, you don't *always* sacrifice personalization for scale. Everyday, data becomes more accessible to find personal data. If you can set up the tech to accomplish both - personalization and volume - you create a deadly effective lead-getting combo.

Action Step. Embrace new technology. Allocate ten to twenty percent of your effort towards brand new untested technology. For example, if you make phone calls five days per week, try out a new dialer or tech one of the days and see how it does compared to your standard dialer.

c) Follow up. More times. More ways. There are two more ways you can get more from your list of names.



First, you try to contact them more than once. Shocker. But wanna know something crazy, most people don't. Here's a different way to think about it. Imagine you really needed to get a hold of your parents because something important came up. What would you do? You'd probably call them, text them, leave a voicemail, etc. And if they still

haven’t responded, what would you do? You'd call and text them again (probably shortly thereafter). It's the same way with prospects. They are in danger of living life without your solution. Be a hero. Save them!

The more ways you try to contact someone, the more likely you are to contact them. People respond to different methods. For example, I never respond to phone calls. But, I reply to direct messages far more.

Contacting someone multiple times multiple ways shows them you are serious. And doing so quickly communicates you have something important to discuss. Curiosity increases because they fear they're missing out.

Personally, I like to email first. You know why? Because most people don’t respond. If someone doesn’t respond to one of your reach out methods, use that as a reason to follow up with another method. *“Hey I’m calling you to follow up about my email.”* We either get a response or a real reason to reach out again. We win either way.

And once you do get them booked for an appointment, expect more than one conversation. Remember, we’re contacting complete strangers. Outreach takes more touch points with people who don’t know you. So expect two to three conversations before a higher ticket sale. Shoot for less, but expect more when you start out.

> Bottom line: Act like you’re *actually* trying to get ahold of these people, rather than going through the motions, and you probably will.

Action Step: Contact each lead multiple times in multiple ways.